Topic vocabulary database

Unit 2

Thinking

assess (v) to carefully consider a situation, person or problem in order to make a judgment: *We tried to assess his suitability for the job.*

assess (v) to calculate what something costs or is worth: *Our agent will assess the value of your property.*

assume (v) to believe that something is true, even though no one has told you or even though you have no proof: *Everyone accepted she was telling the truth, although in fact this was quite a lot to assume.*

baffle (v) if a problem, someone's behaviour, etc baffles you, you cannot understand it or solve it: *Detectives remain baffled by these murders.*

biased (adj) preferring one person, thing or idea to another in a way that is unfair: *It was a biased report.*

concentrate (v) to give all your attention to the thing you are doing: *I was sleeping badly and finding it hard to concentrate.*

consider (v) to think about something carefully before making a decision or developing an opinion: *She paused and considered for a moment.*

consider (v) to have a particular opinion about someone or something: *They consider it inevitable that some jobs will be lost.*

contemplate (v) to consider doing something in the future: *I'm contemplating retirement next year.*

contemplate (v) to think very carefully about something for a long time: *I haven't got time to sit around contemplating the meaning of life.*

cynical (adj) someone who is cynical believes that people care only about themselves and are not sincere or honest, or expects things not to be successful or useful: *I know that some of you are very cynical about the proposals.*

deduce (v) to know something as a result of considering the information or evidence that you have: *Finding fossils far inland, he deduced that the area had once been covered by water.*

deliberate (v) to think about or discuss something very carefully, especially before you make an important decision: *The judges deliberated for an hour before choosing the winner.*

dilemma (n) a situation in which you have to make a difficult decision: *I'm in a dilemma over whether to tell him or not.*

discriminate (v) to treat someone unfairly because of their religion, race or other personal features: *Employers are not allowed to discriminate on the basis of gender.*

discriminate (v) to recognise the difference between things: *Long-range missile attacks simply cannot discriminate between military and civilian targets.*

dubious (adj) not completely good, safe or honest: *The story seemed a bit dubious to me.*

dubious (adj) not sure about the truth or quality of something, or whether you should do something: *I'm very dubious about his ability to do the job.*

estimate (n) an amount that you guess or calculate using the information available: *According to official estimates, over 25% of carbon emissions come from the United States.*

estimate (n) a statement telling a customer how much money you will charge if they employ you to do a particular piece of work: *The committee are currently getting estimates for repairs to the stonework.*

estimate (v) to say what you think an amount or value will be, either by guessing or by using available information to calculate it: *It's difficult to estimate the cost of making your house safe.*

faith (n) strong belief in or trust of someone or something: *I'm delighted to know you have such faith in me.*

gather (v) to believe that something is true, although no one has directly told you about it: *You're new here, I gather.*

genius (n) someone who is much more intelligent or skilful than other people: *She was a mathematical genius.*

genius (n) a very high level of skill or ability: *Baking allows you to show your creative genius.*

grasp (v) to understand something: *He was finding it difficult to grasp the rules of the game.*

guesswork (n) the process of trying to find the answer to something by guessing, or the answer found by using this method: *It was a theory based on pure guesswork.*

hunch (n) a feeling that something is true or will happen, although you do not know any definite facts about it: *I've got a hunch there'll be an election soon.*

ideology (n) a system of ideas and principles on which a political or economic theory is based: *State control is a fundamental aspect of Marxist ideology.*

ingenious (adj) an ingenious plan, piece of equipment, etc uses new and clever ideas: *This is an ingenious device for opening bottles.*

inspiration (n) a sudden feeling of enthusiasm or a new idea that helps you to do or create something: *Dreams are a rich source of inspiration for some writers.*

intuition (n) an ability to know or understand something through your feelings, rather than by considering facts or evidence: *Archaeologists often use their intuition to decide where to dig.*

justify (v) to show that there is a good reason for something, especially something that other people think is wrong: *You'll be expected to justify your actions.*

naïve (adj) a naïve person lacks experience of life and tends to trust other people and believe things too easily: *I was a naïve 17-year-old at the time.*

notion (n) an idea or understanding of something: *I haven't the faintest notion what you're talking about.*

optimistic (adj) someone who is optimistic is hopeful about the future and tends to expect that good things will happen: *She said that she was optimistic about the future of the company.*

optimistic (adj) based on beliefs that are too confident: *That's a very optimistic assessment of the overall situation.*

paradox (n) a person, thing or situation that is strange because they have features or qualities that do not normally exist together: *We get this apparent paradox of people migrating to an area that has very high unemployment.*

pessimistic (adj) someone who is pessimistic is not hopeful about the future and tends to expect that bad things will happen: *She said that she was pessimistic about the future of the company.*

pessimistic (adj) thinking that the worst thing will happen in every situation: *That's a very pessimistic assessment of the overall situation.*

plausible (adj) likely to be true, honest or suitable: *A bomb was the only plausible explanation for the crash.*

ponder (v) to think carefully about something for a long time before reaching a decision: *I'm still pondering whether to tell Janine or not.*

prejudiced (adj) someone who is prejudiced has an unreasonable opinion or feeling about someone or something, especially hatred or fear of a particular group of people: *Rafferty's reporting was clearly biased and prejudiced against the homeless.*

presume (v) to think something is true because it is likely, although you cannot be certain: *I presume you've already ordered lunch.*

query (n) a question that you ask because you want information or because you are not certain about something: *We have a number of queries regarding delivery.*

query (v) to ask a question about something because you have doubts about it: *It is not for us to query his decisions.*

query (v) to ask something: *'Who would do such a thing?' he queried.*

reckon (v) to believe that something is true: *I reckon there's something wrong with him.*

reflect (v) to think about something carefully and seriously: *Josie reflected on how easily she could have been killed.*

sceptical/skeptical (adj) having doubts about something that other people think is true or right: *Harrison approved the plan, but Riley remained sceptical.*

speculate (v) to consider or discuss why something has happened: *We can only speculate on the reasons for his sudden resignation.*

suppose (v) to believe that something is probably true, based on your experience, your knowledge and any other information that you have: *She was about 35, Dexter supposed.*

Learning

academic (adj) relating to education, especially education in colleges and universities: *The book brings together several academic subjects.*

academic (adj) good at learning things by studying: *She's certainly bright, but she's not very academic.*

academic (adj) not relating to a real situation, and therefore not relevant: *Given the lack of funding, any discussion of future plans was somewhat academic.*

academic (n) someone who teaches or does research at a college or university: *The meeting was chaired by a leading Japanese academic.*

conscientious (adj) working hard and being careful to do things well: *Simon is a very conscientious worker.*

cram (v) to study hard in order to learn a lot in a short time, especially for an examination: *My exams are in two weeks, so I'm cramming at the moment.*

curriculum (n) the subjects that students study at a particular school or college: *Our mathematics curriculum is much broader now.*

distance learning (n phr) a system in which students work at home with the help of television and radio broadcasts and send work to their teachers by post or e-mail: *Are you doing the course by distance learning?*

graduate (n) someone who has a degree from a university: *There aren't many careers for history graduates.*

graduate (v) to complete your studies at a university or college, usually by getting a degree: *He graduated from Yale University in 1936.*

ignorant (adj) not knowing something that you should know or need to know: *I was ignorant of the terms used in business.*

inattentive (adj) not giving much attention to someone or something: *I hate speaking in front of an inattentive audience.*

intellectual (adj) relating to the ability to think in an intelligent way and to understand things, especially difficult or complicated ideas and subjects: *Students were asked which task represented the greatest intellectual challenge.*

intellectual (adj) well educated and interested in art, science, literature, etc at an advanced level: *Though not intellectual, my mother was highly intelligent.*

intellectual (n) someone who is well educated and interested in art, science, literature, etc at an advanced level: *Though not an intellectual, my mother was highly intelligent.*

intelligent (adj) good at thinking clearly and quickly, at understanding difficult ideas and subjects, and at gaining and using knowledge: *Surely an intelligent person like you can deal with this?*

intensive (adj) involving a lot of teaching or training in a short time: *It's an intensive language course for beginners.*

knowledgeable (adj) knowing a lot about many different subjects or about one particular subject: *He's extremely knowledgeable about business and finance.*

lecture (n) a talk to a group of people about a particular subject, especially at a college or university: *The course will be taught through a series of lectures and seminars.*

lecture (v) to give a lecture or a series of lectures: *She lectures on Greek Literature at the Sorbonne.*

mock exam (n phr) an examination you take for practice before an important examination: *We've got our mock GCSE exams next month.*

plagiarise (v) to take someone else's work, ideas or words, and use them as if they were your own: *They accused her of plagiarising her speech.*

self-study (n) work that you do without the help of a teacher: *I have to do a lot of self-study on this course.*

seminar (n) a class at a college or university in which a small group of students discusses a subject with a teacher: *We had a very interesting seminar on climate change.*

special needs (n phr) the particular needs of people who are physically or mentally disabled: *If a student has special needs, he or she will be offered additional classes.*

tuition (n) the work that a teacher does when they teach a particular subject, especially to one person or a small group: *He's been getting private tuition in French.*

tutorial (n) a lesson in which a small group of students discuss a subject with a tutor, especially at a university or college: *We had a very interesting tutorial on climate change.*

Unit 4

Change

adapt (v) to change your ideas or behaviour so that you can deal with a new situation: *A successful business is one that adapts to changing situations.*

adjust (v) to change something slightly in order to make it better, more accurate or more effective: *You can adjust the volume using this control here.*

alternate (v) if one thing alternates with another, it happens after it and keeps being repeated: *You go first this game, and then we'll alternate.*

alternate (adj) happening on one day, week, etc, but not on the day, week, etc that immediately follows: *We usually go to visit my grandma on alternate Sundays.*

alternative (n) something that you can choose instead of something else: *Can you suggest an alternative?*

alternative (adj) different from something else and able to be used instead of it: *We're going to have to find an alternative route.*

amend (v) to make changes to a document, law, agreement, etc, especially in order to improve it: *Could you amend the report before you send it?*

conservative (adj) not willing to accept much change, especially in the traditional values of society: *I grew up in a village where most of the people were quite conservative.*

convert (v) to change from one system, use or method to another, or to make something do this: *We're converting to a new computer system at work, so it's chaos at the moment.*

convert (v) to change your beliefs, especially your religious beliefs, or to persuade someone to do this: *I was rather shocked when my dad converted to Islam.*

convert (n) someone who has changed their beliefs in an important way: *I didn't use to like Fiat cars, but now I've become a convert.*

decay (v) to be gradually destroyed as a result of a natural process of change, or to destroy something in this way: *When leaves decay, chemicals are returned to the soil.*

decay (n) the gradual destruction of something as a result of a natural process of change: *Too much sugar in our diets is a major cause of tooth decay.*

deteriorate (v) to become worse: *The situation in the country has deteriorated and tourists are advised not to go there.*

distort (v) to change something such as information so that it is no longer true or accurate: *Journalists often distort statistics in order to tell a good story.*

dynamic (adj) continuously changing, growing or developing: *The world of electronics is a very dynamic area.*

endure (v) to suffer something unpleasant or difficult in a patient way over a long period: *I don't know how people endure the conditions in prison.*

endure (v) to last for a long time: *Shakespeare's works have endured for over 400 years.*

evolve (v) when a type of plant or animal evolves, its physical form changes over a long period of time: *Do you think people will eventually evolve into some kind of superhuman?*

evolve (v) to gradually change and develop over a period of time: *As the computer industry has evolved, everything has got faster and cheaper.*

influence (v) to affect the way someone thinks or behaves or affect the way something happens: *Don't let yourself be influenced by what she says.*

influence (n) the effect that a person or thing has on someone's decisions, opinions or behaviour or on the way something happens: *Picasso has had an enormous influence on many painters.*

innovation (n) a new idea, method, piece of equipment, etc: *This innovation will mean cheap energy for everyone.*

innovative (adj) new, original and advanced: *His first album was innovative, but I've been disappointed by the others.*

last (v) to continue existing or happening for or until a particular time: *The flight lasts five hours.*

maintain (v) to make something stay the same: *I find it hard to maintain my weight.*

mature (v) to start behaving like an adult and become more sensible as you get older: *As you mature, you'll see that things are much more complicated.*

mature (adj) behaving in the sensible way that you would expect an adult to behave: *Why can't you be a bit more mature and stop being so childish?*

modify (v) to change something slightly, especially in order to improve it or to make it less extreme: *We've modified the design to solve the problem.*

novel (adj) new or unusual: *A TV that receives text messages is quite a novel idea.*

persist (v) to continue to do or say something in a determined way: *You'll get yourself into trouble if you persist in behaving in this way.*

potential (n) the possibility to develop or achieve something in the future: *Ed's got a lot of potential as an athlete.*

potential (adj) possible or likely in the future: *I think the book's a potential bestseller.*

progress (v) to continue to develop or move forward: *Your English has really progressed this term.*

progress (n) the process of developing or improving: *I'm not sure that all this technological progress is necessarily a good thing.*

radical (adj) a radical change or way of doing something is new and very different from the usual way: *That's quite a radical suggestion.*

refine (v) to make some changes to something in order to improve it: *You need to refine your argument to make it clearer.*

reform (v) to improve a situation by correcting things that are wrong or unfair, or make a system work more effectively: *The government is planning to reform the health system.*

reform (n) a change intended to correct a situation that is wrong or unfair or make a system work more effectively: *These reforms don't go far enough, in my opinion.*

remain (v) to continue to be in a particular situation or condition: *The interest rate is going to remain at 4%.*

revise (v) to change your opinion or judgment of someone or something: *I think I'm beginning to revise my opinion of Tim.*

revise (v) to change, improve or make additions to something such as a book, law or piece of writing: *Revise your essay and I'll have a look at the changes when you've finished.*

revolution (n) a sudden or major change, especially in ideas or methods: *This invention will lead to a revolution in housework.*

revolution (n) a situation in which people completely change their government or political system, usually by force: *Life was quite difficult in the country following the revolution.*

shift (v) if an idea, attitude or plan shifts or someone shifts it, it changes: *The plan has shifted so we'll need to have another meeting.*

shift (n) a change in something, for example in someone's ideas or opinions: *There has been a real shift in attitudes on this issue.*

spoil (v) to affect something in a way that makes it worse, less attractive or less enjoyable: *Your argument with Bill really spoiled the party.*

status quo (n phr) the present situation or the way things usually are: *Let's just keep the status quo until we know what's happening.*

steady (v) to hold something firmly without shaking or moving it: *Could you just steady the ladder?*

steady (adj) firmly held in a particular position without moving or shaking: *Imogen gave me a steady look.*

steady (adj) staying at the same level, speed, value, etc: *Prices should remain steady over the next few months.*

substitute (v) to remove one thing and put something else in its place: *You can substitute cream with milk, if you have any.*

substitute (n) something that is used instead of something else: *Margarine is a good substitute for butter.*

sustain (v) to provide the conditions in which something can happen or exist: *The atmosphere on Mars won't sustain life.*

switch (v) to replace one object with another: *Someone switched their briefcase for mine when I wasn't looking.*

switch (n) a change from one thing to another: *I knew the magician had changed the cards over but I didn't spot the switch.*

switch (n) something such as a button or key that controls the electrical supply to a light, piece of equipment, machine, etc: *This switch controls the volume.*

transform (v) to make someone or something completely different, usually in a way that makes them more attractive, easier to use, etc: *Jill was completely transformed by her time at university.*

trend (n) a gradual change or development that produces a particular result: *There's a trend towards smaller cars these days.*

uniform (adj) the same everywhere: *You should find that every Hilton hotel offers a uniform standard of service.*

Technology

breakthrough (n) a discovery or achievement that comes after a lot of hard work: *Scientists have finally made the breakthrough they were hoping for.*

broadband (adj) able to send different types of communication signals at the same time: *You need a broadband connection to watch the video.*

broadband (n) a high-speed Internet connection: *Have you got broadband at home yet?*

click (v) to make a computer do something by pressing a button on the mouse: *Click here for more results.*

complex (adj) with a lot of details or small parts, which makes something difficult to understand or deal with: *The issue is too complex for simple solutions.*

consumer electronics (n phr) electrical equipment, such as digital cameras, etc, which is available for the public to buy: *There's just so much choice in the world of consumer electronics these days.*

craft (v) to make or produce something skilfully: *You can see that this basket was crafted by a real expert.*

craft (n) a traditional skill of making things by hand, for example furniture or jewellery: *It's a shame that traditional crafts are fast disappearing.*

data (n) information in a form that a computer can use: *Imagine how much data passes over the Internet each day.*

download (v) to move information to your computer from a computer system or the Internet: *Listen to this song I downloaded from the Internet.*

download (n) a downloaded computer file: *When your download has finished, close this window.*

file (n) a set of information on a computer: *Make sure you save the file somewhere.*

(games) console (n phr) a small piece of electronic equipment that you connect to a screen, used for playing video games: *There's a lot of competition between manufacturers of games consoles.*

manual (adj) operated by people rather than automatically or using computers: *The pilot switched to manual control as the plane approached the runway.*

manual (n) a book containing instructions for doing something, especially for operating a machine: *See what it says about this problem in the manual.*

network (v) to connect computers together so that each computer can send and receive information to and from the other computers: *We've networked all the computers in the office so that we can send files to each other more easily.*

network (n) a set of computers that are connected to each other so that each computer can send and receive information to and from the other computers: *There seems to be a virus on the network.*

nuclear (adj) relating to energy produced by changing the structure of the central part of an atom: *Nuclear power is the only way we can meet our energy needs.*

offline (adj) working on a computer but not connected to the Internet: *Download it now and you can read it when you are offline.*

offline (adv) working on a computer but not connected to the Internet: *You need to go offline to stop the virus spreading.*

online (adj) connected to or available through a computer or a computer network, especially the Internet: *I've started an online library of songs.*

online (adv) on the Internet: *You can find what you need online.*

primitive (adj) at a very simple stage of development, before modern technology: *Da Vinci drew pictures of what we might see as a primitive helicopter.*

programmer (n) someone whose job is to create computer programs: *I'd like to be a programmer and work on computer games.*

resource (n) something you can use to help you to achieve something, especially in your work or study: *The main resource for my research was the library.*

technique (n) a method of doing something using a special skill that you have developed: *I've worked out a new technique to get the computer to do what I want.*

upload (v) to send documents or programs from your computer to a larger system using the Internet: *I'm just uploading something to my website.*

Unit 6
Time

abrupt (adj) sudden and unexpected, often in an unpleasant way: *Our friendship came to an abrupt end.*

anachronism (n) something that is no longer suitable for or relevant to modern times: *She regards the marriage ceremony as a quaint anachronism.*

annual (adj) happening once a year: *We've got our annual conference next month.*

annual (adj) calculated or considered over a period of one year: *You'll receive an annual salary of €100,000.*

antique (adj) old and valuable: *We offer a wide range of antique furniture.*

antique (n) an old object such as a piece of furniture or jewellery that is valuable because it is rare, beautiful or well made: *The desk is an antique.*

century (n) a period of 100 years, usually counted from a year ending in -00. For example, the 20th century is the period from 1900 to 1999: *His family has ruled Morocco since the 17th century.*

chronological (adj) arranged or described in the order in which events happened: *The paintings are presented in chronological order.*

contemporary (adj) modern or relating to the present time: *I'm not very keen on contemporary art.*

contemporary (adj) alive or existing at the same time as a particular event or person: *Contemporary sources offer a very different interpretation.*

contemporary (n) someone alive at the same time as a particular event or person: *Most of his contemporaries regarded him as a mere eccentric.*

decade (n) a period of ten years, especially one beginning with a year that ends in a 0, for example 1990 to 1999: *Prices have risen sharply in the last decade.*

duration (n) the period of time during which something continues to happen or exist: *The duration of the film is 110 minutes.*

elapse (v) if time elapses, it passes: *Another hour elapsed and still the wind continued to howl.*

era (n) a period of time that has a particular quality or character: *We are living in an era in which technology is developing very rapidly.*

eternal (adj) continuing for ever or for a very long time: *She has earned our eternal gratitude.*

expire (v) if an agreement, offer or official document expires, the period of time during which it exists or can be used comes to an end: *The loan offer is due to expire this week.*

frequency (n) the number of times that something happens during a period of time: *Changes in sea temperature will increase the frequency of hurricanes.*

instantaneous (adj) immediate: *Recently developed medical tests can give instantaneous results.*

interim (adj) intended to last or perform an activity only until someone or something permanent or final is available: *This is only an interim report.*

interim (n) the time between one thing happening and another, or while waiting for something permanent or final to become available: *In the interim between John Smith dying and Tony Blair becoming leader, Margaret Beckett acted as leader of the Labour Party.*

interval (n) a period of time between two events: *The normal interval between our meetings is six weeks.*

interval (n) a short break between the parts of something such as a play or concert: *How long is the interval?*

lapse (n) a short or temporary period when you fail or forget to do things in the right way: *The man admitted driving over the speed limit and apologised for the lapse.*

lapse (n) a period of time between two events: *There was a lapse of ten years between his visits.*

lapse (v) to stop gradually or for a short time: *At this point the waiter came up with Maggie's drink and conversation lapsed.*

lapse (v) if an official document, decision or right lapses, it is no longer effective: *The permit was extended for another year before being left to lapse.*

lifetime (n) the period of time when someone is alive: *He achieved a lot in his short lifetime.*

lifetime (n) the length of time that something exists or works: *There are plans to extend the lifetime of the power station.*

long-standing (adj) having existed for a long time: *There's a long-standing tradition in our family of giving presents on Christmas Eve.*

millennium (n) a period of 1,000 years or the beginning of a period of 1,000 years: *People celebrating the millennium filled the streets.*

obsolete (adj) no longer used because of being replaced by something newer and more effective: *Most computer hardware rapidly becomes obsolete.*

overdue (adj) if something is overdue, it should have arrived / been done / been paid / etc before now: *This change in attitude is long overdue.*

period (n) an amount of time during which something happens: *The long dry period ended with torrential rain.*

permanent (adj) happening or existing for a long time or for all time in the future: *She suffered permanent brain damage as a result of the accident.*

phase (n) a particular period of time during the development of something: *The war was about to enter its final phase.*

postpone (v) to decide that something will not be done at the time when it was planned for, but at a later time: *Our exam has been postponed until next Monday.*

prior (adj) happening, existing or done before a particular time: *Illegally parked cars may be removed at any time without prior notice.*

prompt (adj) immediate or quick: *Prompt action is required.*

prompt (adj) happening or arriving at exactly a particular time: *The meeting got off to a prompt start at ten o'clock.*

provisional (adj) intended to be temporary, and likely to be changed when other arrangements are made: *The provisional government lasted three months.*

provisional (adj) if an arrangement is provisional, the people involved have not yet said that they definitely want to do it: *We've made a provisional reservation for next week.*

punctual (adj) arriving or happening at the time agreed on: *Mrs Marsh liked her guests to be punctual.*

seasonal (adj) available only during a particular time of year: *The work was well paid but seasonal.*

seasonal (adj) suitable or typical of the time of year it is now: *We needed to find some seasonal music.*

simultaneous (adj) happening or done at the same time: *In simultaneous announcements, the two men resigned from their jobs.*

span (n) the amount of time that something lasts: *Nearly 100 witnesses testified over a span of 20 days.*

span (v) to last for a particular period of time, especially a long period: *His career spanned half a century.*

spell (n) a period of time, usually a short one: *I had a two-week spell in hospital.*

stint (n) a period of time spent doing something: *He came to California after a brief stint as a waiter in New York.*

subsequent (adj) happening or coming after something else: *In subsequent interviews, Steele has contradicted his original story.*

temporary (adj) existing, done or used for only a limited period of time: *These measures are only temporary.*

timely (adj) happening at the most suitable time: *Thanks to the UN's timely intervention, a crisis was avoided.*

vintage (adj) vintage wine is excellent in quality and was made several years ago: *Let's get some vintage champagne!*

vintage (adj) a vintage object or vehicle is old, but kept in good condition because it is interesting or attractive: *My father has a number of vintage motorcycles.*

vintage (adj) showing the best or most typical qualities of someone: *She turned in a vintage display of tennis to win the title.*

vintage (n) all of the wine produced in a particular year, or the year it was produced: *This year's vintage will be the best in many years.*

vintage (n) the time when something was produced: *He's got a collection of guns of all types and vintages.*

Work

civil service (n phr) a country's government departments and the people who work in them: *How long have you worked for the civil service?*

client (n) someone who pays for or uses the services of a professional person such as a doctor or lawyer: *She advises clients on their investments.*

colleague (n) someone who works in the same organisation or department as you: *Friends and colleagues will remember him with affection.*

consultant (n) an expert or a professional person whose job is to give help and advice on a particular subject: *She's a design consultant.*

consultant (n) a senior doctor in a hospital who is an expert in a particular medical subject: *She's a consultant cardiologist.*

effective (adj) someone or something that is effective works well and produces the result that was intended: *Humour is often far more effective than shouting.*

efficient (adj) someone or something that is efficient works well and produces good results by using the available time, money, supplies, etc in the most effective way: *The new machine is far more efficient than the old one.*

executive (n) a senior manager in a business or other organisation: *We've arranged a meeting with some of the company's top executives.*

fire (v) to make someone leave their job, sometimes as a punishment: *She was fired for refusing to comply with safety regulations.*

headhunt (v) to try to persuade someone to leave their job and go to work for another company: *He was headhunted by a large electronics company.*

leave (n) a period of time away from your job or the armed forces: *Tony, who had been granted leave, was home for several weeks.*

marketing (n) the ways in which a company encourages people to buy its products by deciding on price, type of customer and advertising policy: *Jim, come and meet the firm's new director of marketing.*

multinational (n) a large company that has offices, shops or factories in several countries: *My uncle works for a large multinational.*

multinational (adj) a multinational company or business has offices, shops or factories in several countries: *My uncle works for a large multinational corporation.*

private sector (n phr) all the businesses, industries and services that are not owned or managed by the government: *There is less job security in the private sector.*

promotion (n) a move to a higher level in a company, institution or sport: *We try to fill our executive positions by promotion from within.*

promotion (n) the activity of encouraging or supporting something: *The campaign is concerned with the promotion of health.*

promotion (n) the process of attracting people's attention to a product or event, for example by advertising: *The government's planning to introduce a ban on the promotion of tobacco products.*

prospects (n pl) the possibility that something will happen, especially something good: *The prospects for employment in the technology sector are especially good right now.*

public sector (n phr) the industries and services, for example schools and hospitals, that are supported by tax money and controlled by the government of a country: *The typical member of Parliament has worked elsewhere in the public sector.*

recruit (n) a new member of a military force or an organisation, especially someone who has recently joined: *She's responsible for training new recruits.*

recruit (v) to get someone to work in a company or join an organisation: *We won't be recruiting again until next year.*

recruit (v) to get someone to help you do something: *The club has recruited volunteers to help.*

redundant (adj) if someone is redundant, they have been told they must leave their job because they are no longer needed: *Five thousand miners were made redundant when the tin market collapsed.*

sack (v) to tell someone they can no longer work at their job: *He was sacked after repeatedly arriving late at work.*

strike (n) a period of time during which people refuse to work, as a protest about pay or conditions of work: *A strike by transport workers was held on 12th August.*

strike (v) to refuse to work for a period of time as a protest about your pay or conditions of work: *Pilots were striking for a 6% salary increase.*

union (n) an organisation that represents the workers in a particular industry and tries to improve pay, conditions, etc: *We encourage all employees to join a union.*

Unit 8
Movement

accelerate (v) to happen or make something happen at a faster rate: *I started to feel nervous as the car accelerated.*

approach (v) to move closer to someone or something: *As we approached the airport, we put our seat belts on.*

approach (v) to speak to someone about something for the first time, especially in order to ask for help or make an offer: *I decided to approach Dr Wilson for advice.*

approach (n) a particular way of thinking about or dealing with something: *She has an interesting approach to teaching.*

approach (n) the fact of coming closer in time or in distance: *With the approach of the holidays, we all begin to dream of sunnier places.*

ascend (v) to climb a mountain, stairs, etc: *As we began to ascend the mountain, the weather got worse.*

bounce (v) if a ball or other object bounces, or if you bounce it, it hits a surface then immediately moves away from it: *Stop bouncing that ball against the wall.*

bounce (n) the movement of a ball or other object when it hits a surface and moves away again: *You are allowed one bounce and then you have to catch the ball again.*

clamber (v) to climb something with difficulty, using your hands and feet: *We quickly clambered up the rocks.*

clench (v) if you clench a part of your body such as your hand or your mouth, or if it clenches, you close it tightly, especially because you are angry or upset: *Matt clenched his teeth but didn't say anything.*

clutch (v) to hold someone or something firmly, for example because you are afraid or in pain, or do not want to lose them: *I clutched my passport as we made our way through the busy airport.*

crawl (v) to move along the ground on your hands and knees or with your body close to the ground: *Most babies begin to crawl when they are a few months old.*

creep (v) if someone creeps somewhere, they move there quietly and slowly: *The burglar crept along the corridor.*

dash (v) to run or go somewhere very quickly because you are in a hurry: *I must just dash to the post office.*

descend (v) to go down a mountain or slope, or to go downstairs: *We descended the mountain slowly.*

drift (v) to be pushed along very slowly by the movement of air or water: *The boat must have been drifting for a long time.*

drift (n) a slow and gradual change from one situation or opinion to another: *There's been a drift in public opinion away from supporting the policy.*

drift (n) the meaning that someone is trying to express: *I don't speak French very well, but I got his drift.*

emigrate (v) to leave your country in order to live in another country, on a permanent basis: *My brother is thinking of emigrating to Australia.*

float (v) to rest or move slowly on the surface of a liquid and not sink: *I was floating in the sea when a wave came over my head.*

flow (v) if a liquid flows, it moves smoothly and continuously in one direction: *The River Thames flows from west to east.*

flow (n) the continuous movement of a liquid in one direction: *The flow of water was so powerful that it knocked me off my feet.*

fumble (v) to try to hold, move or find something using your hands in a way that is not skilful or graceful: *She fumbled in her bag and finally found a pen.*

gesture (v) to make a movement with your hands or head in order to show or tell someone something: *Alec gestured towards the photograph on the wall.*

gesture (n) a movement that communicates a feeling or instruction: *Gestures differ from culture to culture.*

glide (v) to move in a smooth and easy way with no noise: *The dancer seemed to glide across the floor.*

grab (v) to take hold of something in a rough or rude way: *It's very rude to grab things out of other people's hands.*

grasp (v) to take and hold something or someone very tightly: *Vicky grasped my hand as we crossed the busy road.*

hop (v) to move forward by jumping on one foot: *Can you hop on one leg?*

hop (n) a quick jump on one foot: *The little girl jumped over the cat with a hop.*

immigrant (n) someone who comes to live in a country from another country: *I don't think it's right that all these immigrants should be allowed to come here.*

jog (v) to run at a slow steady speed, usually for exercise or pleasure: *I jog about five miles every morning.*

jog (n) a run for exercise or pleasure at a slow steady speed: *Do you want to go for a jog?*

leap (v) to jump over something: *He leapt over the table and punched me in the face!*

leap (n) a jump, especially a long or high one: *It'll take a big leap to get over the stream.*

march (v) if soldiers march, they walk in a group with each person matching the speed and movements of the others: *They marched for days to get to the border.*

march (n) a walk by a group of soldiers in which each person matches the speed and movements of the others: *The soldiers were tired after a long march.*

migrate (v) if a bird or animal migrates, it travels to another part of the world for warmer weather at a particular time of the year: *You often see large flocks of birds as they migrate south.*

point (v) to show something by holding out your finger or a long thin object: *I looked where she was pointing.*

punch (v) to hit someone or something with your fist, usually as hard as you can: *Tony punched the wall in anger.*

refugee (n) someone who leaves their country, especially during a war or other threatening event: *More than a million refugees are trying to escape the fighting.*

roam (v) to move or travel with no particular purpose: *We spent the afternoon just roaming the hills.*

roll (v) to move forward while turning over and over: *I spotted a ball rolling towards me and picked it up.*

rotate (v) to move in a circle around a fixed central point, or to move something in this way: *This part rotates, spraying water on all the dirty dishes.*

route (n) the roads or paths that you use when you go from one place to another: *I'm just planning our route for tomorrow.*

sink (v) to disappear below the surface of the water: *The ship sank when it hit an iceberg.*

skid (v) to slide across the ground in an uncontrolled way: *The car skidded on the wet road.*

skid (n) a sudden uncontrolled slide across the ground, especially by a vehicle: *We went into a skid because there was ice on the road.*

skip (v) to move forwards by jumping first on one foot and then the other: *I loved school when I was young and I used to skip all the way there.*

slide (v) to move smoothly and quickly across a surface: *Jason slid a pen to me across the table.*

slide (n) a structure that children play on by climbing up steps and sliding down a slope on the other side: *Let Tammy have a go on the slide now.*

slip (v) if you slip, your feet slide accidentally and you lose your balance or fall over: *I slipped on the stairs.*

step (v) to move by putting one foot down in front of the other: *Would you just step this way, sir?*

step (n) a short movement made by putting one foot in front of the other: *You can get a device that counts how many steps you take in a day.*

step (n) one of a series of actions you do in order to achieve a particular aim: *What's the next step?*

stride (v) to walk with energy and confidence: *The head teacher strode into the room and looked at us.*

stride (n) a long confident step: *In a couple of strides, the speaker had crossed the stage and was ready to start.*

trip (v) to hit your foot on something and fall down: *I tripped as I was going into the bedroom.*

velocity (n) the speed that something moves at in one direction: *Bullets travel at very high velocities.*

wander (v) to travel from place to place, especially on foot, without a particular direction or purpose: *I wandered around the art gallery for an hour.*

wave (v) to move your hand to say hello or goodbye or as a signal: *We waved to Valerie as the train pulled away.*

wave (n) a movement of your hand used for saying hello or goodbye to someone or for giving a signal: *The Queen gave the crowd a quick wave.*

Transport

airline (n) a company that owns aircraft and takes people or goods by plane from one place to another: *I've applied for a job with another airline.*

cargo (n) things that are being sent by ship, plane, train or truck: *It took them all morning to load the cargo.*

carriage (n) one of the vehicles that are joined together to make a train: *The carriage was practically empty when we got on the train.*

charter (v) to hire a boat, plane or bus, especially for use by a group of people: *We decided to charter a plane to take us deeper into the Amazon.*

commute (v) to travel regularly to and from work: *I'm getting fed up with commuting every day.*

destination (n) the place where someone or something is going: *We were all exhausted when we finally reached our destination.*

hiker (n) someone who walks for long distances in the countryside for pleasure: *A group of hikers came over the hill.*

hitchhiker (n) someone who travels by asking other people to take them in their car, by standing at the side of a road and holding out their thumb or a sign: *We picked up a hitchhiker outside Oxford.*

jet lag (n) the feeling of being very tired and sometimes confused because you have travelled quickly on a plane across parts of the world where the time is different: *Polly was suffering from jet lag for a few days.*

legroom (n) the amount of space in front of your seat in which you can stretch your legs: *Let's go business class because you get more legroom.*

load (v) to put a load onto or into something such as a vehicle or container: *Load up the van, and then you can get going.*

load (n) the goods that a vehicle carries: *Try to spread the load evenly inside the lorry.*

passerby (n) someone who is walking past a place, especially when an accident or violent event happens: *The accident was reported to police by a passerby.*

pedestrian (n) someone who is walking, especially in a town or city, instead of driving or riding: *Pedestrians need to be particularly careful at this crossing.*

pier (n) a structure built out from the land over water and used for getting on and off boats: *We walked along the pier and jumped into the boat.*

pilot (v) to fly an aircraft: *I wonder what it's like to pilot a jet.*

pilot (n) someone who flies an aircraft: *The pilot announced that we were about to hit bad weather.*

quay (n) a hard surface next to a sea or river, where boats can stop: *There were fishing boats all along the quay.*

return fare (n phr) the money you pay for a journey to and from a place: *The return fare into town is about a pound.*

round trip (n phr) an occasion when you go somewhere and come back to your starting point again: *The round trip took me about four days.*

steer (v) to control the direction in which a vehicle moves: *You steer the hang-glider by moving your weight from side to side.*

steward (n) a man whose job is to look after the passengers on a plane, train or ship, especially serving them with food and drink: *The steward brought me a blanket.*

Unit 10

Communication

allege (v) to say that something is true or that someone has done something wrong or illegal even though this has not been proved: *The defence alleges that Jones was beaten up while in police custody.*

ambiguous (adj) not clear or definite, capable of being understood in more than one way: *The wording of the law is highly ambiguous.*

assert (v) to state firmly that something is true: *He asserted his innocence.*

blunt (adj) saying what is true or what you think, even if this offends or upsets people: *It was a frank answer to a blunt question.*

boast (n) a statement in which you proudly tell other people what you or someone connected with you has done or can do, or about something you own, especially in order to make them admire you: *For years, their boast was that they were the best club in Europe.*

boast (v) to proudly tell other people about what you or someone connected with you has done or can do, or about something you own, especially in order to make them admire you: *He's always boasting of his great sporting achievements.*

clarification (n) an explanation that makes something clearer and easier to understand: *Please contact us if you require clarification of any of these matters.*

colloquial (adj) used in informal conversation rather than in writing or formal language: *It's a colloquial expression.*

comprehend (v) to understand something: *How could you possibly comprehend the difficulties of my situation?*

confide (v) to tell someone a secret or discuss your private feelings with them: *I hope you know that you can always confide in me.*

confirm (v) to prove that something is true: *The study confirms the findings of earlier research.*

confirm (v) to tell someone, usually by writing or telephoning, that something will definitely happen at the time or in the way that has been arranged: *The date of the meeting is still to be confirmed.*

context (n) the general situation in which something happens, which helps explain it: *These events are meaningless outside their historical context.*

context (n) the words surrounding a particular word that help to give it its meaning: *In this context, 'development' means economic growth.*

contradict (v) to say that the opposite of what someone has said is true: *He didn't dare contradict his parents.*

contradict (v) if one statement, piece of evidence, story, etc contradicts another, they disagree and cannot both be true: *Her account of the accident contradicts that of the other driver.*

convey (v) to communicate ideas or feelings indirectly: *A good photograph can often convey far more than words.*

convey (v) to give official information or a formal message to someone: *Please convey my appreciation to your President.*

declare (v) to announce officially that something is true or happening: *Australia declared its support for the agreement.*

denounce (v) to criticise someone or something severely in public: *American trade policies have been denounced by some European governments.*

disclose (v) to give information to people, especially information that was secret: *Most of the people interviewed requested that their identity should not be disclosed.*

exaggerate (v) to describe something in a way that makes it seem better, worse, larger, more important, etc than it really is: *Don't exaggerate! It wasn't that bad!*

flatter (v) to praise someone in order to get something you want, especially in a way that is not sincere: *You're trying to flatter me, and it won't work.*

gist (n) the main idea or most important point of something that someone has written or said: *I only got the gist of what he was saying.*

hint (n) something that you say to show what you are thinking or feeling, without saying it directly: *He seemed so relaxed and gave no hint that anything was wrong.*

hint (n) a useful suggestion or piece of advice: *This leaflet is full of handy hints about safety in the home.*

hint (v) to say what you are thinking or feeling in an indirect way: *The Prime Minister hinted that the crisis could continue throughout the summer.*

illegible (adj) difficult or impossible to read: *Clare's handwriting is completely illegible!*

inkling (n) a slight idea or small piece of information that tells you that something might exist or be happening: *The first inkling that something was wrong came on Wednesday.*

insist (v) to say very firmly that something must happen or be done: *You must see a doctor immediately; I insist.*

insist (v) to keep saying very firmly that something is true, even when other people will not believe you: *The school insists that it is doing everything it can to cooperate.*

jargon (n) special words and phrases that are only understood by people who do the same kind of work. This word usually shows that you dislike this type of language: *Why do doctors use so much medical jargon in front of patients?*

literal (adj) the literal meaning of a word is its most basic meaning: *He is clearly not using the word 'dead' in its literal sense.*

mumble (n) the saying of something in a way that is not loud or clear enough so that your words are difficult to understand: *He started to say something, but all I could hear was a quiet mumble.*

mumble (v) to say something in a way that is not loud or clear enough so that your words are difficult to understand: *He mumbled something about not wanting to go to work.*

murmur (n) something that is said in a very quiet voice: *'Let's go,' he said in a low murmur.*

murmur (n) a quiet continuous sound: *There was a low murmur of voices coming from the back of the room.*

murmur (v) to say something in a very quiet voice: *Frances murmured an apology as she left.*

petition (n) a document signed by many people that asks someone in authority to do something: *More than 300 villagers have signed a petition against the building project.*

placard (n) a large notice in a public place, used for advertising something or carried in order to protest against or support something: *The Minister was surrounded by placard-waving demonstrators.*

quibble (v) to argue or complain about things that are not important: *There's no point quibbling about the bill.*

rant (n) a long, loud and angry complaint about something: *Dom was on a rant about the cost of eating out.*

rant (v) to complain or talk loudly and angrily for a long time, sometimes saying unreasonable things: *Ned paced back and forth, ranting about some imagined injustice.*

rave (v) to talk in an angry and uncontrolled way: *The boss was raving about nobody doing any work.*

rave (v) to speak or write in a very enthusiastic way about something or someone: *The critics are raving about her performance.*

relevant (adj) important and directly connected to what is being discussed or considered: *Once we have all the relevant information, we can make a decision.*

scribble (n) untidy writing or something written in an untidy way: *The address was written in a scribble so I found it hard to read.*

scribble (v) to write something quickly and carelessly: *Tony scribbled the address on the back of an envelope.*

scribble (v) to make marks or drawings with no meaning: *A child had scribbled on the book.*

slang (adj) slang words or expressions are very informal and are not considered suitable for more formal situations: *In some areas 'scran' is a slang word for food.*

slang (n) words or expressions that are very informal and are not considered suitable for more formal situations: *I picked up a lot of army slang while I was doing my military service.*

stumble (n) a mistake while speaking: *He read well, with only a few small stumbles.*

stumble (v) to make a mistake when you are speaking: *Children often stumble when reading aloud.*

stutter (n) a problem in speaking that causes you to repeat some particular sounds more than you should: *When I was small I spoke with a stutter.*

stutter (v) to repeat the sounds of words in an uncontrolled way when you speak because you are nervous or have a speech problem: *Richard stuttered a reply and sat down, his face red.*

tip (n) a useful suggestion: *The booklet gives a lot of useful tips on flower arranging.*

utter (v) to say something: *As soon as he'd uttered the words he regretted them.*

utter (v) to make a sound: *She uttered a sound somewhere between joy and pain.*

vague (adj) not clear or complete: *Some aspects of the law were somewhat vague and ill-defined.*

The media

anchor (n) someone who presents the news on a television or radio news programme: *Diane Sawyer is co-anchor of ABC's Prime Time Live.*

anchor (v) to present a television or radio programme, especially the news: *The programme has been anchored by McDonald since 2005.*

broadcast (n) a programme that is broadcast: *Channel 5's main news broadcast is at 9 pm.*

broadcast (v) to send out messages or programmes to be received by radios or televisions: broadcast (something) on something: *The President's speech will be broadcast on all channels at 6.00 this evening.*

broadcast (v) to tell people something, especially something that you wanted to be a secret: *You don't have to broadcast my news to the whole world!*

caption (n) words printed near or on a picture that explain something about the picture: *What does the caption beneath the photo say?*

columnist (n) a journalist who writes a regular series of articles for a particular newspaper or magazine: *She's a columnist for a Sunday newspaper.*

correspondent (n) a newspaper or television reporter, especially one who deals with a particular subject or area: *And now, a special report from our political correspondent John Sergeant.*

coverage (n) news about something on television or radio or in the newspapers, sometimes used about the amount of attention that television, radio and newspapers give to something, or the way in which something is reported: *Their coverage of the riot was criticised for ignoring its causes.*

coverage (n) information about a range of things, for example in a book or course of education: *The course offers good coverage of the subject.*

critic (n) someone who does not like something and states their opinion about it: *Critics say the plan is short-sighted and dangerous.*

critic (n) someone whose job is to write or broadcast their opinions about things such as books, films or plays: *Michael is the paper's literary critic.*

footnote (n) a note at the bottom of a page that gives more detailed information about something on the page: *There's more information on this in the footnote at the bottom.*

ghostwriter (n) someone who writes something for someone else whose name will appear on it as the writer: *He didn't really write his autobiography himself – a ghostwriter did it.*

handbook (n) a small book that gives information about a subject or instructions about how to use something: *It's a very good handbook for those new to windsurfing.*

manifesto (n) a formal statement expressing the aims and plans of a group or organisation, especially a political party: *The Liberal Party has just published its latest manifesto.*

novelist (n) someone who writes novels: *Several politicians are also successful novelists.*

pamphlet (n) a very thin book with a paper cover, usually given free to people: *The nurse gave me a pamphlet about injections you need before going abroad.*

prerecorded (adj) prerecorded messages, music, television or radio programmes have been recorded so that they can be used later: *The Prime Minister's announcement wasn't live – it was prerecorded.*

reviewer (n) someone whose job is to write articles in a newspaper or magazine giving their opinion about a new play, book, art exhibition, etc: *Most of the reviewers loved the exhibition.*

spine (n) the edge of a book where all the pages are fixed together: *Don't bend the book back – you'll damage the spine.*

subtitles (n) a translation of what people are saying in a foreign language film or television programme that appears at the bottom of the screen: *Foreign films in Britain aren't usually dubbed; they have subtitles.*

supplement (n) a separate part of a newspaper or magazine: *I love reading the colour supplement that comes with the paper on a Sunday.*

tabloid (adj) relating to newspapers with fairly small pages mostly containing stories about famous people and not much serious news: *I'd hate to be a tabloid journalist.*

tabloid (n) a newspaper with fairly small pages mostly containing stories about famous people and not much serious news: *Never believe anything you read in a tabloid!*

trailer (n) an advertisement for a film or television programme that shows a short part of that film or programme: *Did you see the trailer for the new Samuel L. Jackson movie?*

Unit 12
Chance

approximate (v) to calculate something in a way that is not exact: *The journey was approximated to take about seven hours.*

approximate (adj) not exact, but close to an exact amount, number, time, etc: *The approximate time of the incident was 7:30.*

ascribe (v) to believe something is the cause of something else: *The failure of the business was ascribed to events beyond anyone's control.*

assign (v) to send someone to a particular place, especially in order for them to work there: *I've been assigned to the office in Manchester.*

attribute (v) to believe that something is the result of a particular situation, event or person's actions: *Police attributed the accident to the bad weather.*

blow (n) an event that causes you to feel very sad, disappointed or shocked: *Failing to get into university was a real blow.*

cause (v) to make something happen, usually something bad: *What caused the building to collapse?*

cause (n) an event, thing or person that makes something happen: *The cause of the fire still hasn't been found.*

coincidence (n) a situation in which separate things happen by chance at the same time or in the same way: *It's just a coincidence that Sandra and I were both in New York at the same time.*

curse (v) to use magic powers to make bad things happen to someone: *I have such bad luck that sometimes I think I've been cursed.*

curse (n) a bad situation or event caused by someone's deliberate use of their magic powers: *They say that there's a curse on whoever steals anything from the pyramids.*

deliberate (adj) intended, not done by chance or by accident: *I'm sure what she did wasn't deliberate.*

determine (v) to calculate something or discover it by examining evidence: *Investigators have determined that the crash was the result of human error.*

fate (n) a power that some people believe controls everything that happens in their lives: *I like to just leave things to fate.*

fluctuate (v) to change frequently: *The price of gold has fluctuated quite a lot in recent months.*

foresee (v) to see or know something that will happen in the future: *We don't foresee any problems.*

freak (n) something with very unusual features that make it very different from other things of its type: *People think I'm a bit of a freak because I like silent films.*

freak (adj) extremely unusual and unexpected: *Some people were injured in a freak storm.*

gamble (v) to risk money or something valuable in the hope of winning more if you are lucky or if you guess something correctly: *I never gamble what I can't afford to lose.*

haphazard (adj) done in a way that does not seem to be carefully planned or organised: *The town seems to have grown in quite a haphazard way.*

hazard (n) something that could be dangerous or cause damage or accidents: *Dad suddenly braked because he saw a hazard in the road.*

inadvertent (adj) not deliberate: *Not inviting William was entirely inadvertent, I assure you.*

instrumental (adj) involved in an important way in making something happen: *He was instrumental in saving the company.*

jinxed (adj) someone or something that is jinxed has a lot of bad luck: *You must be jinxed if you've been hit by lightning three times.*

likelihood (n) how certain it is that something will happen: *The likelihood of success is quite low.*

lucky charm (n phr) something that people believe brings them luck: *I always take my lucky charm into the exam with me.*

meander (v) to move slowly without a particular direction or purpose in mind: *We meandered around the park.*

mishap (n) a minor mistake or accident: *We had a few mishaps on the way, but at least we're here now.*

mutate (v) to become physically different from other plants or animals of the same type as a result of a genetic change: *Radiation has caused plants in the area to mutate.*

odds (n) the chances of something happening: *What are the odds on winning the lottery?*

pick (v) to choose someone or something from a group: *Mrs Kay picked me to help her give out the books.*

pick (n) choice: *We've got lots of different bikes for sale, so take your pick.*

pot luck (n phr) a situation in which you do not know what to expect, but you hope that it will be good: *You can't predict the weather in Britain in the summer, so it's just pot luck what it'll be like for our holiday.*

random (adj) chosen or happening without any particular method, pattern or purpose: *Think of a random number.*

sign (n) a piece of evidence that something is happening or that something exists: *There were signs that someone had been there before us.*

speculate (v) to consider or discuss why something has happened: *He refused to speculate on what might happen.*

spontaneous (adj) happening in a natural way without being planned or thought about: *Leaving my job was a spontaneous thing.*

startle (v) to make a person or animal feel suddenly frightened or surprised by doing something they do not expect: *Liam startled me when he suddenly appeared next to me.*

statistics (n) a group of numbers that represent facts or describe a situation: *But the statistics simply don't support that view.*

stray (v) to move away from the correct place or path: *Little Red Riding Hood's grandmother warned her not to stray from the path.*

stray (adj) lost or without a home: *The number of stray dogs is becoming a real problem.*

stray (n) a pet that is lost or has left its home: *There are too many strays around here.*

superstition (n) a belief that things such as magic or luck have the power to affect your life: *You don't believe that old superstition about the number 13, do you?*

superstitious (adj) believing in the power of magic or luck: *I'm quite superstitious, so I never walk under ladders.*

transpire (v) to happen: *Perhaps we will never know what transpired that night.*

uncertainty (n) the fact that something is not known or has not been decided: *The passengers began to get angry because of the uncertainty.*

wobble (v) to rock slightly from side to side, or to make something do this: *The statue wobbled and then fell over.*

Nature

agriculture (n) the work, business or study of farming: *I'm thinking of studying agriculture.*

appreciate (v) to understand the true nature of a situation, and realise why it is important or serious: *I'm not sure you appreciate how important this is.*

appreciate (v) to be grateful for something: *I really appreciate your help.*

catastrophe (n) an event that causes a lot of damage or makes a lot of people suffer: *Many people lost their lives in the catastrophe.*

crop (n) a plant grown for food, usually on a farm: *Coffee is an important crop in Brazil.*

drought (n) a long period of time when there is little or no rain and crops die: *The drought means that there's an increased risk of fire.*

evacuate (v) to leave a building or other place because it is not safe: *When the alarm went off, everyone evacuated the building.*

exploit (v) to use natural resources such as trees, water or oil so that you gain as much as possible: *We could make a lot of money if we exploit our natural resources in the right way.*

exploit (v) to treat someone unfairly in order to get some benefit for yourself: *In some countries, children are exploited in factories.*

famine (n) a serious lack of food that continues for a long time and causes many people in a country to become ill or die: *We're raising money to help victims of the famine.*

flood (v) if water floods a place, it covers it: *The river flooded the whole city.*

flood (n) a large amount of water that covers an area that was dry before: *The flood caused millions of euros of damage.*

fossil fuels (n phr) fuels such as coal or oil, made from decayed material from animals or plants that lived many thousands of years ago: *Burning fossil fuels gives off carbon dioxide.*

global warming (n phr) an increase in the average temperature of the Earth: *It's difficult to deny that global warming is really happening.*

greenery (n) green plants that are growing somewhere or used as decoration: *I like living here because there's quite a lot of greenery.*

habitat (n) the type of place that an animal normally lives in or a plant normally grows in: *The panda is threatened by the disappearance of its habitat.*

harvest (v) to collect a crop from the fields: *They were harvesting the grapes when we were in France.*

harvest (n) the time when a crop is collected: *Everyone helps during the harvest.*

hurricane (n) a violent storm with extremely strong winds and heavy rain: *A hurricane is expected to hit the coast this evening.*

instinct (n) a natural tendency to behave in a particular way that people and animals are born with and that they obey without knowing why: *Birds build nests by instinct.*

natural disaster (n phr) something very bad that happens and causes a lot of damage or kills a lot of people: *It's not possible to prevent most natural disasters.*

resource (n) things such as coal, trees and oil that exist in nature and can be used by people: *The country's main resource is the vast oil fields.*

scarce (adj) if something is scarce, there is not very much of it: *Badgers are becoming increasingly scarce in Britain.*

species (n) a plant or animal group whose members all have similar general features and are able to produce young plants or animals together: *Scientists have discovered a new species of monkey.*

Unit 14

Quantity

abundant (adj) existing or available in large quantities: *The country has an abundant supply of fossil fuels.*

ample (adj) enough, and often more than you need: *There is ample evidence to prove his guilt.*

area (n) a place on the surface of something such as a part of your body: *Be sure to apply sunblock to sensitive areas of your skin.*

area (n) the amount of space that the surface of a place or shape covers: *The surface area of the screen should be at least one square metre.*

average (adj) around a usual or ordinary level or standard: *He's about average height.*

average (adj) not very good: *It was a decidedly average performance.*

average (adj) calculated by adding a group of numbers together and dividing the total by the amount of numbers: *The winds had an average speed of 15 miles per hour.*

average (n) the amount, level, standard, etc that is typical of a group of people or things: *Incomes here are nowhere near the national average.*

average (n) an amount that is calculated by adding several numbers together and dividing the total by the original number of things you added together: *Add 20, 10 and 30 and find the average.*

batch (n) a number of things or people that arrive or are dealt with at the same time: *This new batch of students seems very nice.*

batch (v) to group things together: *Let's batch these envelopes into piles of 100.*

bulk (n) something that is very large, wide and solid: *We looked up at the great dark bulk of the cathedral.*

bulk (n) the majority or largest part of something: *Women still undertake the bulk of domestic work in the home.*

bulk (n) if something is bought or sold in bulk, it is bought or sold in large quantities: *Supermarkets only buy produce in bulk.*

considerable (adj) large in size, amount or degree: *She made a considerable amount of money.*

countless (adj) very many, especially more than you think is reasonable: *She's made countless television appearances.*

dimension (n) a part of a situation, especially when it influences the way you think about the situation: *Doing voluntary work has added a whole new dimension to my life.*

dimension (n) length, height or width: *A hologram represents an object in three dimensions.*

diminish (v) to become less: *The intensity of the sound diminished gradually.*

diminish (v) to make something become less: *The delay may well have diminished the impact of their campaign.*

equation (n) a statement in mathematics that two sets of numbers or expressions are equal: *Solve the equation 5x - 3 = 27.*

equation (n) all the different aspects that you have to consider in a situation: *In a choice between the use of rail and car, the question of cost will come into the equation.*

equidistant (adj) at the same distance from two places: *The port is conveniently equidistant from the two major manufacturing centres.*

expand (v) to become or make larger in size and fill more space: *The water froze inside the pipe, causing it to expand and burst.*

extent (n) the importance of a problem or situation: *We were shocked by the extent of the damage.*

extent (n) the degree to which something happens or is likely to happen: *The extent to which your diet is successful depends on your willpower.*

extent (n) the size or area of something: *Open the table to its fullest extent.*

finite (adj) existing only in limited numbers or amounts or continuing only for a limited time or distance: *The world's finite resources must be used wisely.*

force (n) physical strength or violence: *They accused the police of using excessive force during the arrest.*

force (n) the influence or powerful effect that someone has: *We have convinced people by the force of our argument.*

force (n) a power that makes an object move or changes the way it moves: *It fell because of the force of gravity.*

force (v) to make someone do something that they do not want to do, for example by using or threatening to use violence: *He claims that police officers forced him to sign a confession.*

force (v) to use physical force to move something in a particular direction: *She forced the package through the slot.*

fraction (n) a small part or amount of something: *His shares are now worth a fraction of their former value.*

fraction (n) a division or part of a whole number, for example 1/2 or 3/4: *0.5 can also be written as a fraction: 1/2.*

heap (n) a large pile of something, especially an untidy pile: *His clothes were in a crumpled heap on the floor.*

heap (v) to make a big untidy pile of things: *Bundles of clothing were heaped on the floor.*

imbalance (n) a situation in which the balance between two things is not equal or fair: *There's an increasing social imbalance in recruitment to higher education.*

immense (adj) extremely large: *An immense amount of money has already been spent on the project.*

intensity (n) strength: *The cross-examination increased in intensity.*

magnitude (n) great size, importance or effect: *We hadn't grasped the magnitude of the task we were facing.*

major (adj) important, serious, large or great: *Age is a major factor affecting chances of employment.*

mass (n) a large quantity or number: *There's a mass of competing antivirus programs you can choose from.*

mass (n) the amount of physical matter an object contains: *This rock has a mass of 1 kg.*

meagre (adj) smaller or less than you want or need: *There was only a meagre food supply.*

minor (adj) not very important in comparison with people or things of the same type: *Some minor changes may be necessary.*

minute (adj) very small: *The soil contained minute quantities of uranium.*

multiple (adj) involving or consisting of many people, things or parts: *Words can have multiple meanings.*

multiple (n) a number that you can divide by a smaller number an exact number of times: *12 is a multiple of four.*

proportion (n) a quantity of something that is a part or share of the whole: *Only a small proportion of graduates fail to find employment.*

quantify (v) to measure or describe something as a quantity: *The benefits are difficult to quantify.*

rate (n) the number of times something happens, or the number of examples of something within a particular period of time: *There's been a dramatic fall in the city's crime rate.*

rate (n) the speed at which something happens within a particular period of time: *The population was growing at an alarming rate.*

rate (v) to consider that someone or something has a particular quality or has achieved a particular standard or level: *In a recent poll, the environment is rated as the number one issue by 30% of the voters.*

ratio (n) a relationship between two things expressed as two numbers or amounts: *The ratio of expenditure to revenue was an alarming 4:1.*

ration (n) a limited amount of something, especially food, that you are allowed to have, for example when there is not much available or when someone else is controlling it: *There's a ration of two eggs per person.*

ration (v) to control the supply of something such as food so that people are allowed only a fixed amount: *During the strike, petrol had to be rationed.*

shrink (v) to become or make something smaller in size: *Do you think this dress will shrink if I handwash it?*

sufficient (adj) as much as is needed: *Bedside lighting alone is not sufficient for most bedrooms.*

sum (n) an amount of money: *He was fined a sum of £1,000.*

sum (n) a simple calculation: *John's just starting to do sums at school.*

uneven (adj) not regular in terms of size, length, quality or quantity: *The economy has prospered, but growth has been uneven.*

vast (adj) extremely large: *We found ourselves on a vast empty plain.*

volume (n) an amount of something: *The total volume of trade has reached £800 million.*

volume (n) the amount of space something takes or can be filled with: *The petrol tank has a volume of over 20 gallons.*

widespread (adj) happening or existing in many places, or affecting many people: *The project has received widespread public support.*

Money

benefit (n) money or other help that the government gives people who need financial help, for example because they do not have a job: *There has been an increase in the number of people claiming benefit.*

benefit (n) an advantage you get from a situation: *The new sports centre will bring lasting benefit to the community.*

benefit (v) to get help or an advantage from something: *Thousands of households could benefit under the scheme.*

compensation (n) money that someone receives because something bad has happened to them: *Victims of the world's largest industrial accident were paid $470 million compensation.*

damages (n) money that a court orders you to pay someone because you have harmed them or their property: *The jury awarded damages of over $9 million to the victims.*

debt (n) an amount of money that you owe: *By this time we had debts of over £15,000.*

deduct (v) to take an amount or number from a total: *Nothing will be deducted from your pay without your consent.*

deposit (n) a first payment that you make when you agree to buy or rent something expensive such as a car or house: *She paid a £500 deposit, and agreed to pay the balance within six months.*

deposit (n) an amount of money that you pay into a bank account: *He made a £2,000 cash deposit on 5th April.*

deposit (v) to pay money into a bank account: *Billions of dollars are deposited in banks every day.*

direct debit (n phr) an order to a bank to regularly pay money from your account to a person or organisation: *I pay all my bills by direct debit.*

dividend (n) a share of the profits of a company, paid once or twice a year to the people who own the company's shares: *The company will not be paying shareholders a dividend this year.*

down payment (n phr) a first payment that you make when you are buying something and are going to pay the rest later: *She made a £500 down payment, and agreed to pay the balance within six months.*

finance (n) decisions on how money is spent or invested: *He's now studying international banking and finance.*

finance (n) money that is used to pay for something such as a large project: *The college has had to close due to lack of finance.*

finance (v) to pay for something such as a large project: *The scheme is being financed by the Arts Council.*

insurance (n) an arrangement in which you regularly pay an insurance company or other organisation an amount of money so that they will give you money if something you own is damaged, lost or stolen, or if you die or are ill or injured: *You have to take out building and contents insurance as a condition of the mortgage.*

interest (n) money that a person or institution such as a bank charges you for lending you money: *You will repay the money with interest, as agreed in the contract.*

investment (n) money used in a way that may earn you more money, for example money used for buying property or shares in a company: *Her investments were mainly in technology stocks.*

investment (n) the process of spending money in order to improve something or make it more successful: *Lack of investment had led to a decline in public services.*

lump sum (n phr) money in a single large payment rather than small separate payments: *Are you going to pay the whole amount in one lump sum?*

mortgage (n) a legal agreement in which you borrow money from a bank in order to buy a house. You pay back your mortgage by making monthly payments: *On my present salary I can't get a mortgage.*

overdraft (n) an agreement with your bank that allows you to spend money when you have no money left in your account: *Hefty fines are payable for those who exceed their overdraft limit.*

pension (n) an amount of money that someone who no longer works because of their age or an illness, etc is paid regularly, either by a company they once worked for or by the government: *He started drawing his pension last year.*

share (n) one of the equal parts of a company that you can buy as a way of investing money: *The scheme allows employees to buy shares in the company.*

speculate (v) to take the risk of investing your money in a company in the hope that you can make a big profit later by selling the shares you buy: *Have you been speculating on the stock market?*

withdraw (v) to take money from a bank account: *You can withdraw cash at any of our branches.*

Unit 16

Materials

block (v) to stop something from moving through or along something else: *A large rock blocked our way.*

block (n) a solid piece of wood, stone, ice, etc with straight sides: *Have you ever seen someone make a swan out of a block of ice?*

brittle (adj) a brittle substance or object is hard and can easily break into pieces: *The plastic had gone brittle from sitting in the sun.*

chip (v) if something hard chips, or you chip it, a small piece of it breaks off: *I've chipped a tooth.*

chip (n) a small piece of something such as wood or glass, especially when it has broken off something: *Be careful because there might be chips of glass on the floor.*

compact (v) to make something smaller or firmer by pressing it, or to become smaller or firmer like this: *Some places compact rubbish so it doesn't take up so much space.*

compact (adj) smaller than most things of the same kind: *Our flat is quite compact.*

concentrate (v) make a solution of something in water stronger: *You can concentrate the solution by heating it.*

crack (v) to damage something so that a line or long narrow hole appears on its surface, but it does not break into pieces: *Who cracked the window?*

crack (n) a line on a surface where something is beginning to break apart: *How long has that crack in the ceiling been there?*

crumb (n) a very small piece that falls off a dry food such as bread or cake: *Don't get crumbs on the carpet.*

crush (v) to hit or press something so hard that you damage it severely or destroy it, especially by making its shape flatter: *Crush the can and put it in the recycling bin.*

crush (n) a crowd of people all extremely close together in an area that is too small for them: *There was quite a crush in the club last night.*

dense (adj) a dense substance is very heavy in relation to its size: *Lead is a very dense metal.*

dilute (v) to make a liquid less strong by adding water or another liquid: *I find orange juice a bit strong, so I usually dilute it.*

dilute (adj) a dilute liquid has been mixed with another liquid to make it less strong: *Use dilute bleach to clean the table.*

dissolve (v) if a solid substance dissolves in a liquid, it is mixed into the liquid so that it becomes included in it: *Salt dissolves quite easily in water.*

fabric (n) cloth, especially when it is used for making things such as clothes or curtains: *We need to choose the fabric we want for the curtains.*

firm (adj) solid but not hard: *When the cake feels firm, remove it from the oven.*

flake (v) to come off a surface in small flat pieces: *The paint on the door is beginning to flake.*

flake (n) a small flat piece of something: *The floor was covered in flakes of paint from the old walls.*

fragile (adj) easy to break or damage: *Be careful with that ornament because it's very fragile.*

friction (n) the physical force that makes it difficult for one surface to move over another: *If you rub your hands together, friction makes them get warm.*

grain (n) a very small individual piece of a substance such as sand, salt or sugar: *Each grain of salt is really a tiny cube.*

gravity (n) the force that makes something fall to the ground: *How do they measure gravity?*

grind (v) to break something into very small pieces or powder, by using a machine or by crushing it between two hard surfaces: *I often grind my own spices.*

hollow (adj) empty inside: *I was surprised to find that the tree was hollow.*

liquid (n) a substance that can flow, has no fixed shape, and is not a solid or gas: *Did you know that glass is actually a liquid?*

liquid (adj) in the form of a liquid: *You have to be careful when you're handling liquid explosive.*

lump (v) to put people or things into the same group, although they do not really belong together: *You can't just lump all disabled people together like that.*

lump (n) a solid piece of something that does not have a regular shape: *I tripped over a lump of concrete.*

mineral (n) a natural substance in the earth, for example coal, salt, gold or diamonds: *This area is very rich in minerals.*

mould (v) to give something a particular shape or form: *Mould the clay into the shape of a person.*

mould (n) a shaped container into which you pour a liquid that then becomes solid in the shape of the container: *Pour the jelly into the mould and then put it in the fridge.*

opaque (adj) opaque glass, liquid, etc is difficult to see through: *We've had opaque glass put into the bathroom.*

pat (v) to touch someone gently several times with a flat hand to show that you care about them or want to make them feel better: *He patted me on the shoulder and told me not to worry.*

pat (n) the action of gently touching someone or something several times with a flat hand: *I felt a pat on my back and turned round.*

pile (v) to put a large number of things on top of each other: *Don't just pile your clothes on the bed.*

pile (n) a number of things put on top of each other: *Could you help me carry this pile of books?*

polish (v) to rub the surface of something in order to make it shine: *The maid polished the table and then cleaned the floor.*

polish (n) a chemical substance that you rub onto an object to make it shine: *Put some polish on your cloth and then rub, like this.*

scratch (v) to pull your nails along your skin, especially because you have an itch that makes you want to do this: *You'll only make it worse if you scratch.*

scratch (v) to damage a surface by marking it with something sharp or rough: *How did you scratch your violin?*

scratch (n) a thin mark on a surface: *There's a scratch on my new CD!*

scrub (v) to wash or clean something by rubbing it hard, especially with a brush: *I've been scrubbing the floor all day.*

scrub (n) a thorough wash or clean: *What your fingernails need is a good scrub.*

smash (v) to break something noisily into many pieces by dropping or hitting it with a lot of force: *You've smashed the glass on my favourite picture!*

solid (n) a substance that is not a liquid or a gas: *Water is a liquid, but ice is a solid.*

solid (adj) a solid substance is firm and hard and is not a liquid or a gas: *The concrete should be solid by now.*

speck (n) a very small spot or mark: *There isn't a speck of dust in the house.*

squash (v) to damage something by pressing or crushing it and making it lose its normal shape: *She sat on my glasses and squashed them!*

squash (n) a situation in which there are too many people in a small space: *It'll be a bit of a squash, but we can get five in the car.*

squeeze (v) to press something firmly, especially with your hands: *Squeeze the sponge to get all the water out.*

squeeze (n) the action of squeezing something: *She gave my hand a quick squeeze.*

stack (v) to arrange things so that they stand one on top of another: *The assistant was stacking boxes when I walked into the shop.*

stack (n) a pile of things placed one on top of another: *I can't believe you knocked over that stack of tins!*

stiff (adj) firm and difficult to bend: *Take a stiff piece of card and cut a hole in it.*

stroke (v) to gently move your hand over skin, hair or fur: *I was only trying to stroke the dog!*

stroke (n) a gentle movement of your hand across skin, hair or fur: *I fell asleep while my mum was stroking my hair.*

stuff (v) to push something soft into a space or container: *I stuffed a few things into a suitcase and set off.*

stuff (n) a variety of objects or things: *What's all this stuff on your desk?*

substance (n) a particular type of liquid, solid or gas: *You're not allowed to take certain substances on a plane.*

synthetic (adj) made from artificial materials or substances, not from natural ones: *Nylon is a synthetic material.*

tear (v) to pull something so that it separates into pieces or gets a hole in it, or to become damaged in this way: *I've torn my T-shirt on the door handle.*

tear (n) a hole in a piece of paper, cloth, etc where it has been torn: *There's a big tear in my dress.*

texture (n) the way something feels when you touch it: *I love the texture of silk.*

transparent (adj) a transparent object or substance is clear or thin enough for you to see things through: *Glass is transparent.*

The built environment

built-up (adj) a built-up area has a lot of buildings in it: *This area has become really quite built-up over the last few years.*

bypass (v) to avoid the centre of a town or city by using a road that goes round it: *If we take the other road, we can bypass Reading altogether.*

bypass (n) a road that goes round a town or city so that you can avoid going through its centre: *I don't think they'll ever finish the new bypass.*

construct (v) to build something large or complicated, such as a bridge or road: *We plan to construct a new bridge across the river.*

demolish (v) to deliberately destroy a building: *They've demolished my old school.*

district (n) an area of a town or country: *It's quite a nice district to live in.*

dwell (v) to live somewhere: *The little old man dwelt in a rundown cottage.*

estate (n) an area where there are many houses, usually built at the same time by the same company: *There's a lot of crime on this estate.*

evict (v) to legally force someone to leave the house they are living in, usually because they have not paid their rent: *The letter says they're going to evict us.*

high-rise (adj) a high-rise building is very tall with many floors or levels: *I couldn't live in a high-rise block.*

housing (n) buildings for people to live in: *The government needs to build more housing for the poor.*

infrastructure (n) the set of systems within a place or organisation that affect how well it operates, for example the telephone and transport systems in a country: *During the war, a lot of the infrastructure of the country was destroyed.*

inner city (n phr) an area near the centre of a large city where a lot of poverty and other social problems exist: *There's some very interesting music coming out of the inner city these days.*

occupy (v) if someone occupies a room, building, area of land, seat, bed or other place during a period of time, they use it: *Patients with minor illnesses are occupying beds that are needed for more serious cases.*

populated (adj) a populated area has people living there: *Luckily, the fire didn't spread to populated areas.*

skyline (n) the shapes made by buildings or mountains when you see them against the sky: *I love the London skyline.*

skyscraper (n) a very tall building containing offices or flats: *Skyscrapers started to appear in the 1930s.*

structure (n) something large such as a building or a bridge that is built from different parts: *The large structure outside town is going to be the new stadium.*

suburban (adj) relating to an area or town near a large city but away from its centre, where there are many houses, especially for middleclass people: *Many people would love to live in suburban areas but can't afford it.*

surroundings (n pl) all the things that are present in a place and that form the experience of being there: *I wish I lived in more pleasant surroundings.*

urban (adj) relating to towns and cities, or happening there: *There needs to be more investment in urban areas.*

Unit 18
Reactions

acknowledge (v) to accept or admit that something exists, is true or is real: *He never acknowledges his mistakes.*

acknowledge (v) to thank someone for something they have done or given you, especially in writing or by saying it publicly: *We gratefully acknowledge the contributions of everyone who helped us.*

acknowledge (v) to show that you have seen someone or that you recognise them, for example by smiling or speaking to them: *They barely acknowledge each other in public.*

agonise (v) to spend a long time worrying and being upset about something: *For years I agonised over whether I could have helped my daughter.*

apathy (n) a feeling of having no interest in or enthusiasm about anything, or of not being willing to make any effort to change things: *Few people voted in the election, presumably just because of apathy.*

avoid (v) to try to prevent something from happening: *Try to avoid confrontation.*

avoid (v) to try not to go near someone or something: *We went early to avoid the crowds.*

avoid (v) to choose not to do something in order to achieve a better result: *When taking this medication it is advisable to avoid alcohol.*

behaviour (n) the way that someone or something behaves: *Anna was sick of her brother's behaviour.*

chuckle (n) a quiet laugh: *There were a couple of chuckles from one member of the audience.*

chuckle (v) to laugh quietly, especially in a private or secret way: *As she read her book, she chuckled softly.*

comfort (n) a physically relaxed state, without any pain or other unpleasant feelings: *The airline is keen to improve passenger comfort.*

comfort (n) a feeling of being less sad or worried about something than you were previously: *My mother was always there to offer comfort.*

comfort (n) a pleasant way of life in which you have everything you need: *Now he can live in comfort for the rest of his life.*

comfort (v) to make someone feel less sad, worried or disappointed: *He went upstairs to comfort the baby.*

conduct (n) the way someone behaves, especially in relation to particular rules or accepted ways of behaving: *Two players were sent off for violent conduct.*

conduct (v) to do something in an organised way: *The agreement doesn't allow you to conduct business from your home.*

consequence (n) a result or effect of something: *She said exactly what she felt, without fear of the consequences.*

contentment (n) the happiness you feel when you have everything you want and you enjoy your life: *He has found contentment and satisfaction in his work.*

cross (adj) angry: *The neighbours got cross every time we put our music on.*

dignity (n) the impressive behaviour of someone who controls their emotions in a difficult situation: *She faced all her problems with dignity.*

disgust (n) a very strong feeling of not liking something: *The idea of eating meat fills me with disgust.*

disgust (v) if something disgusts you, it is so bad or immoral that it makes you angry and upset: *Your whole attitude disgusts me.*

disillusioned (adj) disappointed because you have discovered that someone or something is not as good as you had believed: *Voters are very disillusioned with the democratic process.*

fed up (adj) annoyed or bored with something that you feel you have accepted for too long: *I'm fed up with this job.*

giggle (n) a high laugh, especially a nervous or silly one: *The sound of giggles came from the girls' room.*

giggle (v) to laugh in a nervous, excited or silly way that is difficult to control: *The children whispered and giggled all the way through the film.*

glance (n) a quick look at someone or something: *She had a quick glance at the newspaper as she gulped down her coffee.*

glance (v) to look somewhere quickly and then look away: *He glanced over his shoulder nervously.*

glimpse (n) an occasion when you see someone or something for a moment only: *The crowd were anxious for a glimpse of the President.*

glimpse (v) to see someone or something for a moment or not completely: *He glimpsed a short white-haired figure heading for the back gate.*

gloat (v) to show that you are happy and proud at your own success or at someone else's failure: *He was there to gloat over their defeat.*

glum (adj) looking sad, as if you expect something bad to happen: *You look a bit glum. Has something happened?*

grimace (n) an ugly expression that you make by twisting your face, for example because you are in pain or do not like something: *His tortured grimace showed he was in pain.*

grimace (v) to make an ugly expression by twisting your face, for example because you are in pain or do not like something: *She grimaced as she swallowed the medicine.*

grin (n) a big smile that shows your teeth: *'A great win,' Mike said with a broad grin.*

grin (v) to smile showing your teeth: *Ruth grinned at him as she waved goodbye.*

handle (v) to take action to deal with a difficult situation: *The government was criticised for the way it handled the crisis.*

impatient (adj) annoyed because something is not happening as quickly as you want or in the way you want: *'Come on!' said Maggie, becoming impatient.*

inertia (n) a situation in which something does not change for a long time: *There's so much inertia on the committee that nothing ever gets done.*

manners (n) traditionally accepted ways of behaving that show a polite respect for other people: *Children learn manners by observing their parents.*

manoeuvre (n) an action or movement that you need care or skill to do: *Dexter tried every manoeuvre he could to overtake the truck.*

manoeuvre (v) to move someone or something in a situation that needs care or skill: *Katherine's good at manoeuvring her car through heavy traffic.*

moan (n) an annoying complaint, especially about something that is not important: *I haven't got time to listen to your moans and groans.*

moan (n) a long low sound you make because of pain, sadness or pleasure: *She let out a low moan of anguish.*

moan (v) to complain about something in an annoying way: *Ben was moaning about his job again.*

moan (v) if someone moans, they make a long low sound because of pain, sadness or pleasure: *James continued to moan loudly as the pain intensified.*

mock (v) to make someone or something look stupid by laughing at them, copying them, or saying something that is not kind: *Are you trying to mock me?*

neglect (n) the failure to give someone or something the care or attention they need: *There's an important need to protect children from abuse and neglect.*

neglect (v) to fail to look after someone when you are responsible for them: *What should we do about parents who neglect their children?*

neglect (v) to fail to do something that you should do: *He couldn't neglect his duties as an officer.*

peep (n) a quick look at something: *I'll just take a peep inside.*

peep (v) to look at something quickly and secretly, usually from a place where you think you cannot be seen: *She tried to peep through the gates to see the garden.*

peer (v) to look very carefully, especially because something is difficult to see: *She was peering through the window.*

prevent (v) to stop something from happening or stop someone from doing something: *Regular cleaning may help prevent infection.*

rejoice (v) to feel very happy about something, or to celebrate something in a happy way: *Montaigne seemed to rejoice in the humiliation of others.*

resent (v) to experience angry, unhappy feelings because you think you have been treated unfairly or without enough respect: *The girls in the family resented all the attention that Peter was getting.*

resolute (adj) extremely determined: *We're resolute in our determination to oppose these measures.*

smirk (n) an unpleasant smile: *Wipe that smirk off your face!*

smirk (v) to smile in an unpleasant way because something bad has happened to someone else, or because you think you have achieved an advantage over them: *I know you've won, but there's no need to smirk.*

snap (v) to suddenly lose control and become extremely angry or upset because a situation has become too annoying or difficult: *She was bound to snap under all that pressure.*

snap (v) to speak to someone in a sudden, angry way: *'What do you want now?' he snapped angrily.*

tactic (n) a particular method or plan for achieving something: *The governor's tactics involved accusing his opponent of being too liberal.*

terror (n) a strong feeling of fear: *Thousands of islanders fled in terror yesterday as the volcano erupted.*

terror (n) violence used for making people very frightened in order to achieve political aims: *This is a deliberate campaign of terror.*

Health

administer (v) to give someone a drug or medical treatment: *The drugs are administered intravenously.*

admit (v) to take someone into hospital for medical treatment: *After collapsing, she was rushed to hospital, where she was admitted.*

agony (n) great pain: *William fell to the ground, writhing in agony.*

agony (n) a strong and unpleasant feeling, especially great worry or sadness: *Waiting for the results was agony.*

antidote (n) a substance that prevents a poison from having bad effects: *It's a snake bite. Quick – get the antidote!*

consultant (n) a senior doctor in a hospital who is an expert in a particular medical subject: *She's a consultant cardiologist.*

diagnosis (n) a statement about what disease someone has, based on examining them: *Her doctor made a diagnosis of appendicitis.*

inoculate (v) to protect someone against a particular disease by injecting a medicine containing a small amount of the disease into them, so that their body becomes immune to it: *None of the family had been inoculated against diphtheria.*

irritation (n) a painful feeling in a part of the body, often with red skin or swelling: *Some drugs can cause stomach irritation.*

numb (adj) a part of your body that is numb has no feeling: *After hours of sitting on the floor, her legs had gone numb.*

numb (adj) not able to react or to show your emotions, often because of an extreme shock: *I was numb with fear.*

nursing home (n phr) an institution where old people live when they are too old or ill to look after themselves without help: *My grandmother's moving into a nursing home next week.*

paralysis (n) the loss of the ability to move your body or a part of it, usually because of an injury or illness: *The syndrome can lead to sudden paralysis.*

plaster (n) a thin piece of cloth or plastic that is sticky on one side, and that you put on your skin to cover a cut: *I've cut my finger. Have you got a plaster?*

plaster (n) if a part of someone's body is in plaster, it has a hard cover around it to protect a broken bone: *One man had his leg in plaster, having broken it in an accident.*

prescribe (v) if a doctor prescribes a drug or treatment, they say you should have it: *The drug should not be taken unless prescribed by a doctor.*

prevent(at)ive medicine (n phr) medical examinations, treatments, advice, etc intended to prevent illness or discover it before it becomes serious: *The government should invest more in preventive medicine.*

prognosis (n) a doctor's opinion about the way in which a disease or illness is likely to develop: *What's the prognosis, doctor?*

sick leave (n phr) a period of time during which you do not work because you are ill: *Mr Jenkins is away on sick leave today.*

side effect (n phr) an effect of a medicine that is not intended and could be unpleasant: *The treatment has no significant side effects.*

syringe (n) a needle fitted to a plastic tube, used for taking blood from your body or for putting medicine or drugs into it: *Take the syringe and inject the patient.*

vaccine (n) a substance put into the body, usually by injection, in order to provide protection against a disease: *Is there an effective vaccine for meningitis?*

ward (n) a large room in a hospital with beds for people to stay in: *Jo is a staff nurse working on the maternity ward.*

Unit 20

Power

aggression (n) an angry feeling that makes you want to attack or defeat someone else: *You're going to have to learn to control your aggression.*

authority (n) the power to make decisions or tell people what to do: *You don't have the authority to do that.*

benign (adj) kind and nice: *He might seem benign, but keep an eye on him.*

bully (v) to frighten or hurt someone who is smaller or weaker than you: *The boss just tries to bully everyone in the office.*

bully (n) someone who frightens or hurts someone who is smaller or weaker than they are: *I was a bit of a bully when I was at school.*

command (v) to officially order someone to do something: *The general commanded the army to attack.*

command (n) an official order: *The dog understands my every command.*

conquer (v) to take control of land or people using soldiers: *The Spanish conquered South America in the sixteenth century.*

conquer (v) to gain control of a situation or emotion by making a great physical or mental effort: *I tried hard to conquer my fear.*

consent (v) to give approval for something: *You can't go on the school trip unless your parents consent to it.*

consent (n) permission to do something: *The police shouldn't be allowed to enter your house without your consent.*

controversy (n) a disagreement, especially about a public policy or a moral issue that a lot of people have strong feelings about: *There's a lot of controversy surrounding the new law.*

dictator (n) someone who uses force to take and keep power in a country: *How did the dictator come to power?*

dominate (v) to control something or someone, often in a negative way, because you have more power or influence: *Don't allow him to dominate the conversation all the time.*

eliminate (v) to get rid of something that is not wanted or needed: *Will we ever eliminate the threat from pollution?*

enforce (v) to make sure that a law or rule is obeyed by people: *It'll be impossible to enforce the new law.*

entitled (adj) having the right to do something: *Students are entitled to a special discount on books.*

exempt (adj) allowed to ignore something such as a rule, obligation or payment: *At the moment, women are exempt from national service.*

former (adj) used for describing someone or something that had a particular job, title, status, etc in the past, but not now: *The former Prime Minister of India is visiting the UK.*

impose (v) to introduce something such as a new law or new system, and force people to accept it: *These rules are being imposed without anyone's opinion being asked.*

inferior (adj) not as good as something else: *Street markets often sell inferior quality electrical goods.*

intimidate (v) to deliberately make someone feel frightened especially so that they will do what you want: *Richard often tries to intimidate people.*

label (v) to use a word or phrase to describe someone or something, especially one that is not completely fair or true: *Don't label all young people in the same way.*

label (n) a word or phrase that is used to describe someone or something, especially one that is not completely fair or true: *I wish people wouldn't try to put a label on me.*

label (n) a piece of paper or material fastened to an object that gives information about it: *I don't know what's in this tin because the label has come off.*

liberate (v) to give someone the freedom to do what they want, for example by taking them out of a situation in which their behaviour is controlled: *Leaving school and getting a job really liberated me.*

mainstream (n) ideas, methods or people that are considered ordinary or normal and accepted by most people: *Life can be more difficult if you're not part of the mainstream.*

mainstream (adj) considered ordinary or normal and accepted or used by most people: *Most mainstream politicians have dismissed the suggestion.*

master (v) to learn something thoroughly so that you know it or can do it very well: *It took me over ten years to master the piano.*

master (n) a man who has control over servants or other people who work for him: *Servants should show respect to their master at all times.*

minister (n) an official in charge of a government department in the UK and other countries: *The Minister responsible for this decision should resign.*

monarch (n) a king or queen: *The monarch represents the country abroad.*

prohibit (v) to officially stop something from being done, especially by making it illegal: *The sale of lottery tickets to children is prohibited.*

reign (v) if a king or queen reigns, they officially rule a country: *Queen Victoria reigned during a time of great change.*

reign (n) the period of time when a king or queen rules a country: *What's the longest reign of any king or queen?*

reinforce (v) to make an idea, belief or feeling stronger: *Stories like this in the media reinforce the idea that all young black men are criminals.*

reluctant (adj) not willing to do something: *I'm reluctant to invite Tracy to the wedding.*

resist (v) to oppose or fight against someone or something: *The Prime Minister resisted a lot of pressure to change his mind.*

resist (v) to stop yourself from doing something that you would very much like to do: *I can't resist chocolate!*

restrict (v) to keep something within strict limits: *Many parents restrict the number of hours their children watch TV.*

society (n) people in general living together in organised communities, with laws and traditions controlling the way they behave towards one another: *People have much more freedom in today's society.*

subject (v) to make someone experience something unpleasant: *They subjected the poor prisoner to torture.*

subject (n) an idea, problem, situation, etc that you discuss or write about: *What subject have you chosen for your essay?*

subject (n) someone who lives in a country that is controlled by a king or queen: *I'm proud to be a British subject.*

subjective (adj) based on your own feelings and ideas and not on facts: *That's just your subjective opinion.*

submit (v) to accept that someone has defeated you or has power over you: *The boy only stopped hitting me when I submitted.*

summon (v) to officially order someone to come to a place, especially a court of law: *She was summoned to appear before the court.*

superior (adj) better than someone or something else in quality or skill: *His early work is vastly superior to the later pieces.*

undermine (v) to make something or someone become gradually less effective, confident or successful: *This unfortunate incident undermines all the hard work we've put in.*

unrest (n) angry or violent behaviour by people who are protesting against something: *Politicians held a special meeting to discuss the unrest in the country.*

victimise (v) to treat someone in a deliberately unfair way: *It's not right to victimise someone in that way.*

vulnerable (adj) someone who is vulnerable is weak or easy to hurt physically or mentally: *I felt quite vulnerable walking home late at night.*

Social issues

abolish (v) to officially get rid of a law, system, practice, etc: *The law was abolished in 1963.*

advocate (v) to publicly support a particular policy or way of doing things: *Do you advocate corporal punishment in schools?*

alleviate (v) to make something less painful, severe or serious: *These measures are designed to alleviate suffering among the elderly.*

bureaucracy (n) a complicated and annoying system of rules and processes: *I started to set up my own business but there was too much bureaucracy.*

charity (n) an organisation to which you give money so that it can give money and help to people who are poor or ill, or who need advice and support: *There are one or two charities that I make regular donations to.*

class (n) one of the groups into which people in a society are divided according to their family background, education, job or income: *My family are very middle class in a lot of ways.*

community (n) the people who live in an area: *Politics should begin in the local community.*

convict (v) to prove in a court of law that someone is guilty of a crime: *He was convicted of murder.*

convict (n) someone who is in prison because they have committed a crime: *Two convicts have escaped from the local prison.*

corruption (n) dishonest or illegal behaviour by officials or people in positions of power, especially when they accept money in exchange for doing things for someone: *They've started an investigation into corruption.*

deterrent (n) something that makes people decide not to do something by making them realise that something unpleasant could happen to them: *I think capital punishment serves as a deterrent.*

heritage (n) the art, buildings, traditions and beliefs that a society considers important to its history and culture: *It's important that we preserve our national heritage.*

immigration (n) the process in which people enter a country in order to live there permanently: *Is the level of immigration actually rising, or is it falling?*

industrial action (n phr) a protest in which workers show that they disagree with a policy of their employer, for example by striking: *Unless something changes, we'll be taking industrial action.*

institution (n) a large organisation such as a bank, hospital, university or prison: *It's hard spending all your life inside an institution like a children's home.*

legislation (n) a law or set of laws: *There is already legislation to prevent that.*

prejudice (n) an unreasonable opinion or feeling, especially the feeling of not liking a particular group of people: *Many women have had to deal with prejudice in the workplace.*

prison reform (n phr) changes intended to make the prison system fairer or more effective: *I'm a great believer in prison reform.*

privileged (adj) having advantages and opportunities that other people do not have, because you have a lot of money or high social status: *I suppose I come from quite a privileged background.*

prosecute (v) to officially accuse someone of a crime and ask a court of law to judge them: *The police decided not to prosecute and let him off with a warning.*

state (n) the government of a country: *The health system is the state's responsibility.*

Unit 22
Quality

aggravate (v) to make something bad become worse, especially a situation or a medical condition: *His headache was aggravated by all the noise.*

better (v) to achieve a better result than someone or something: *Bradman's average score of 96 has never been bettered.*

better (v) to improve something: *It's an important step towards bettering relations between the two countries.*

blemish (n) a mark or spot that spoils the appearance of something: *The painting was spoiled for me by a blemish on the frame.*

chaos (n) a situation in which everything is confused and in a mess: *There have been severe floods, bringing chaos to the region.*

cheapen (v) to make someone or something seem less valuable or respected: *This type of advertising cheapens the image of the brand.*

contaminate (v) to make something dirty, polluted or poisonous by adding a chemical, waste or infection: *Industrial sewage continues to contaminate our beaches.*

decay (v) to make or become gradually worse in quality, or weaker in power or influence: *Too much sugar will decay your teeth.*

decline (v) to become less or worse: *The number of people buying their own homes has declined.*

defective (adj) not made correctly or not working correctly: *The car was found to have defective brakes.*

detrimental (adj) harmful or damaging: *Overexposure to sunlight can have a detrimental effect on the skin.*

devastate (v) to seriously damage or completely destroy something: *Western India was devastated by a huge earthquake.*

devastate (v) to make someone feel very shocked and upset: *Mary's sisters were devastated by her disappearance.*

enhance (v) to improve something, or make it more attractive or more valuable: *The measures taken should considerably enhance the residents' quality of life.*

evaluate (v) to think carefully about something before making a judgment about its value, importance or quality: *The performance of each employee is evaluated once a year.*

exacerbate (v) to make a problem become worse: *Complaining will only exacerbate an already difficult situation.*

exquisite (adj) extremely beautiful and delicate: *It was an exquisite hand-painted vase from China.*

first-rate (adj) of the highest quality: *The service is first-rate.*

flaw (n) a mistake or fault in something that makes it useless, less effective or less beautiful: *There are serious flaws in the way we train our teachers.*

ideal (adj) of the best or most suitable type: *The fair provides an ideal opportunity for job seekers and employers to meet.*

ideal (adj) as good as you can imagine, and probably too good to be real: *In an ideal world there would be no poverty.*

inadequate (adj) not enough or not good enough for a particular purpose: *We are trying to provide basic education with inadequate resources.*

invaluable (adj) extremely useful: *The Internet is an invaluable resource for students.*

optimum (adj) best or most suitable within a range of possibilities: *The warm water provides the optimum conditions for breeding.*

optimum (n) the best or most suitable situation, level or amount: *The optimum we should be producing is 100 units per hour.*

outclass (v) to be much better than someone or something else: *The team was completely outclassed by the opposition.*

prime (adj) most important, most suitable or of the highest quality: *Our prime concern was the safety of our customers.*

redeeming feature (n phr) a positive quality which improves something that is not very good by including something that is good: *Smith's only redeeming feature is that he knows his job.*

refurbish (v) to improve a room or a building by cleaning and painting it, adding new furniture or equipment, etc: *They're planning to refurbish the teachers' room.*

reinforce (v) to make an idea, belief or feeling stronger: *The latest figures reinforce the view that economic growth is slowing.*

reinforce (v) to make a building, structure or object stronger: *Crews started work today to reinforce the seriously damaged bridge.*

renovate (v) to make something old look new again by repairing and improving it, especially a building: *The council's planning to renovate the old fire station.*

rotten (adj) something that is rotten has decayed: *There was a horrible smell of rotten eggs.*

rotten (adj) of a low quality, standard or ability: *She's a rotten singer.*

rusty (adj) a rusty metal object is covered in rust: *I don't know why you bought that rusty old car.*

satisfactory (adj) good enough to be accepted in a particular situation: *I have still not received a satisfactory answer to my question.*

satisfactory (adj) enjoyable and pleasing: *This new arrangement proved highly satisfactory to us all.*

shambles (n) something that is very badly organised and does not operate effectively: *Government corruption has left the economy in a shambles.*

shoddy (adj) shoddy work, services or products are of a very low standard: *The work they did on the new road was very shoddy in places.*

sound (adj) involving the use of good judgment, and therefore likely to be effective: *Administrators should make sure the programmes are legally sound.*

sound (adj) thorough: *You'll need a sound understanding of basic teaching skills before you enter the classroom.*

stale (adj) stale food such as bread is old and no longer fresh: *Wrap the bread up well or it'll go stale.*

streamline (v) to improve a business, organisation, process, etc by making it more modern or simple: *We need to streamline the whole process.*

strengthen (v) to make something stronger: *The bridge will need to be strengthened.*

surpass (v) to be better or greater than something else, or better than what was expected or hoped for: *Winning the gold medal surpassed my wildest dreams.*

ultimate (adj) happening at the end of a process or activity: *The incident affected the ultimate outcome of the war.*

ultimate (adj) as good or as bad as possible: *The house provides the ultimate luxury retreat.*

worsen (v) to become worse, or to make something worse: *The weather worsened, and temperatures fell.*

wreck (n) something that has been badly damaged: *The car was a wreck after the accident.*

wreck (v) to severely damage: *The town has been wrecked by the bombing.*

The arts

abstract (adj) abstract art expresses the artist's ideas or feelings rather than showing the exact appearance of people or things: *I'm not very keen on abstract paintings.*

abstract (n) an abstract painting or design: *You're not supposed to understand what it is; it's an abstract!*

auction (n) a public occasion when things are sold to the people who offer the most money for them: *They bought the paintings at auction in 1989.*

audition (n) a short performance in which you sing, dance or act so that someone can decide if you are good enough to perform in a particular play, concert, etc: *I've got an audition for the school play tomorrow.*

bestseller (n) a book that many people buy: *His first novel was a bestseller.*

collector's item (n phr) a rare or valuable object that collectors want to own: *Do you think this watch is a collector's item?*

curator (n) someone whose job is to look after the objects in a museum: *Ask the curator – he'll be able to tell you more about it.*

fine art (n phr) objects such as paintings that are created to be looked at because they are beautiful or interesting (note: the fine arts = activities in which people create beautiful or interesting objects, for example painting and sculpture): *I'm thinking of studying fine art at university.*

installation (n) a piece of art that consists of several different objects or pictures arranged to produce a particular effect: *There's an interesting installation at the Tate Gallery at the moment.*

lines (n pl) the words that an actor says in a performance: *He forgot his lines.*

lyrics (n pl) the words of a song: *I've written the music but haven't written any lyrics yet.*

masterpiece (n) an excellent painting, book, piece of music, etc, or the best work of art that a particular artist, writer, musician, etc has ever produced: *Vertigo is the film widely regarded as Hitchcock's masterpiece.*

paperback (n) a book with a cover made of thick paper: *His collection of poetry is now out in paperback.*

period (adj) typical of a particular historical time: *Will you be wearing period costumes in the play?*

period (n) a particular time in history: *Their collection is confined solely to the Roman period.*

priceless (adj) very valuable and impossible to replace: *These are priceless jewels.*

recital (n) a performance of music or poetry: *Are you coming to the piano recital tonight?*

retrospective (adj) relating to or considering things that happened in the past: *The show takes a retrospective look at the 1970s.*

retrospective (n) an exhibition that includes examples of a particular artist's work from their whole career: *I really want to go to the Norman Rockwell retrospective.*

score (n) the music written for a film, play, etc: *Who wrote the musical score for Star Wars?*

sketch (n) a drawing made quickly that does not have many details: *Draw a rough sketch of the dog.*

sketch (n) a short funny scene performed within a longer show: *She toured Europe with a programme of songs and sketches.*

sketch (v) to draw a picture quickly and with few details: *I'll just sketch a rough outline of the house.*

work of art (n phr) something such as a painting or sculpture that is of very high quality: *There are many priceless works of art in the Louvre.*

work of art (n phr) something that is made or done in a skilful or attractive way: *Her house is a real work of art.*

worthless (adj) not having any value or good qualities, or not useful: *The country's currency is nearly worthless.*

Unit 24

Relationships

adjacent (adj) next to or near something else: *The theatre is adjacent to the library.*

attach (v) to fasten or join one thing to another: *You need to attach these two parts.*

bond (v) to fix two things firmly together, usually with glue, or to become fixed in this way: *It's not easy to bond plastic and metal together.*

bond (n) the way that two surfaces are stuck together, usually with glue: *The bond should be strong enough to support quite a lot of weight.*

bond (n) something that gives people or groups a reason to love one another or feel they have a duty to one another: *We were at school together, so there's quite a strong bond between us.*

coexist (v) to live or exist at the same time or in the same place: *Two different species of bear coexist in this area.*

coherent (adj) a coherent statement is reasonable and sensible: *You need to rewrite your essay so that your argument is more coherent.*

compatible (adj) likely to have a good relationship because of being similar: *I suppose Lisa and I just weren't compatible.*

comprise (v) to consist of two or more things: *The country comprises a number of independent areas.*

compromise (v) to solve a problem or end an argument by accepting that you cannot have everything that you want: *Young children have to learn how to compromise.*

compromise (n) a way of solving a problem or ending an argument in which both people or groups accept that they cannot have everything they want: *You'll just have to find a compromise.*

conflict (v) if different ideas or opinions conflict, they cannot all be right or cannot all happen: *This statement conflicts with what the Prime Minister said earlier.*

conflict (n) angry disagreement between people or groups: *Many people have died in the conflict.*

confront (v) to go close to someone in a threatening way: *A man in a suit confronted me as I tried to enter the building.*

confront (v) to deal with a difficult situation: *It's best to just confront the problem head on.*

consistent (adj) not changing in behaviour, attitudes or qualities: *He might be strict, but at least he's consistent.*

contradict (v) to say that the opposite of what someone has said is true: *I wish you wouldn't contradict me all the time.*

contradict (v) if one statement, piece of evidence, story, etc contradicts another, they disagree and cannot both be true: *What the witness said contradicted the accused man's story.*

contrasting (adj) different from each other in a noticeable or interesting way: *They write in contrasting styles.*

cooperate (v) to work with other people to achieve a result that is good for everyone involved: *We can achieve more if we cooperate.*

correspond (v) to be the same as something else or very much like it: *The two accounts of the incident correspond with each other.*

dispute (v) to say that something such as a fact is not true or correct: *I'm not disputing the facts, just your interpretation of them.*

dispute (n) a serious disagreement, especially one between groups of people that lasts for a long time: *The dispute seems likely to continue.*

distinguish (v) to recognise the differences between things: *I couldn't distinguish between the expensive coffee and the cheap brand.*

diverse (adj) very different from each other: *Our English teacher knows a lot about quite a diverse range of subjects.*

divorce (v) to take legal action to end your marriage: *She divorced her husband about ten years ago.*

divorce (n) a legal way of ending a marriage: *I've been meaning to tell you for some time now that I'd like a divorce.*

equivalent (n) someone or something that has the same size, value, importance or meaning as someone or something else: *There's no equivalent for that word in English.*

equivalent (adj) of the same size, value, importance or meaning as something else: *We can either give you a refund or you can exchange the item for one of equivalent value.*

exclude (v) to deliberately not include something: *Excluding ourselves, we're inviting 18 people to the party.*

external (adj) coming from outside a place or organisation: *You'll be interviewed by an external examiner.*

external (adj) on or from the outside of something such as a building or someone's body: *This cream is for external use only.*

identify (v) to recognise someone and be able to say who they are: *The witness wasn't able to identify the man.*

identify with (v) feel that you can understand and share someone else's feelings: *I could really identify with the character of Melissa in the film.*

integral (adj) forming an essential part of something and needed to make it complete: *Learning to forgive is an integral part of growing up.*

integrate (v) to make someone become a full member of a group or society and be involved completely in its activities: *I think that people who come to this country should make an effort to integrate.*

interfere (v) to deliberately become involved in a situation and try to influence the way that it develops, although you have no right to do this: *Stop interfering in my relationship with Jane!*

intermediate (adj) in between two stages, places, levels, times, etc: *You can't become a pilot without going through a lot of intermediate steps along the way.*

intermediate (adj) at an academic level below advanced: *This course is aimed at intermediate learners.*

internal (adj) existing or happening inside an object, a building or your body: *We've decided to knock down one of the internal walls.*

intervene (v) to become involved in a situation in order to try to stop or change it: *The fight could have got ugly if the teacher hadn't intervened.*

intimate (adj) an intimate relationship is a very close personal relationship, especially a sexual one: *Martin seems to have problems being intimate with people.*

intimate (adj) relating to very private or personal things: *I record all my most intimate thoughts in my diary.*

involve (v) to include something as a necessary part of an activity, event or situation: *Getting your degree is going to involve quite a lot of hard work, you know.*

joint (adj) involving two or more people or done by them together: *We decided to open a joint bank account.*

liken (v) to say that someone or something is similar to someone or something else: *Mary likened herself to Bill Gates, and I suppose they have got one or two things in common.*

link (v) if people, things or events are linked, they are related to each other in some way: *Do you think this robbery is linked to the one that happened last week?*

link (v) to say or show that two things are related, or that one of the things causes the other: *The psychiatrist linked how I felt to the problems I'd had as a child.*

link (n) a connection between two or more people, places, facts or events, especially when one is affected or caused by the other: *There's a strong link between the power of the USA and the spread of English.*

merge (v) if two organisations merge, or you merge them, they combine to form one bigger organisation: *I might lose my job when the two businesses merge.*

mutual (adj) felt or done in the same way by each of two or more people: *John doesn't like me, and the feeling is mutual.*

negotiate (v) to try to reach an agreement by discussing something in a formal way, especially in a business or political situation: *We've managed to negotiate a discount of 20%.*

related (adj) if two or more things are related, there is a connection between them: *Your illness is related to the stress you are under at work.*

relative (adj) having a particular quality when compared to something else: *After the failure of his first film, the last one was a relative success.*

resemblance (n) if there is a resemblance between two people or things, they are similar, especially in their appearance: *Can you see the resemblance between me and my father?*

People

acquaintance (n) someone you know a little, who is not a close friend: *He's not really a friend, more of an acquaintance.*

adopt (v) to decide to start using a particular idea, plan or method: *I adopted the method the coach showed me and I played far better.*

adopt (v) to take someone else's child into your family and legally make him or her your own child: *After two years in a children's home, Adam was adopted by a very nice young couple.*

ancestor (n) someone who is related to you who lived a long time ago: *My ancestors all came from the same part of China.*

citizen (n) someone who has the right to live permanently in a particular country and has the right to the legal and social benefits of that country as well as legal obligations towards it: *The man took out his passport to prove he was an American citizen.*

companion (n) someone who is with you: *The prize is a holiday for you and a companion.*

dependant (n) a child or other relative to whom you give food, money and a home: *I couldn't believe it when I heard how many dependants he's got.*

descendant (n) a relative of a person who lived in the past: *Did I tell you that I'm a descendant of Lord Byron?*

empathise (v) to understand how someone feels because you can imagine what it is like to be them: *I've had a similar experience, so I can empathise.*

extrovert (n) someone who is very confident, lively and likes social situations: *Michelle is such an extrovert and loves meeting new people.*

foster (v) to look after a child as part of your family for a period of time because the child's parents cannot look after them: *My parents have fostered lots of children over the years.*

guardian (n) someone who is legally responsible for another person such as a child, whose parents have died: *You need to get the form signed by a parent or guardian.*

introvert (n) someone who tends to concentrate on their own thoughts and feelings rather than communicating with other people: *I'm more of an introvert and prefer to spend time on my own.*

partner (n) someone that you do a particular activity with: *Nadine and I are partners at tennis sometimes.*

partner (n) someone that you live with and have a sexual relationship with: *The invitation is for me and my partner.*

peer (n) someone who is of the same age as another person: *What your peers think of you can be very important.*

predecessor (n) the person who had a job or official position before someone else: *I hope to avoid making my predecessor's mistakes.*

sibling (n) your siblings are your brothers and sisters: *The elder sibling in a family is often more successful in his or her career.*

spouse (n) a husband or wife: *Each spouse is responsible for paying their own income tax.*

stepmother/son/etc (n) someone's stepmother/son/etc is their mother/son/etc because of a second marriage, not because of a biological connection: *When my dad remarried, I didn't really get on with my stepmother.*

successor (n) someone who has a position after someone else: *I hope my successor enjoys the job as much as I have.*

sympathise (v) to behave in a kind way and show that you understand someone's problems: *Why can't you sympathise with people, instead of blaming them for their problems?*

Unit 26
Preference

addiction (n) a strong need that someone feels to regularly take an illegal or harmful drug: *I developed an addiction to the medicine my doctor had prescribed for me.*

adore (v) to love someone/something very much: *I absolutely adore Indian food!*

anticipation (n) a feeling of excitement about something enjoyable that is going to happen soon: *I waited in anticipation for the show to begin.*

appeal (v) to ask people to do something or to behave in a particular way, especially in a difficult situation: *The Minister has appealed for people not to panic.*

appeal (v) if something appeals to you, you like it or want it: *A holiday in Ireland doesn't really appeal to me.*

appeal (n) a quality that something has that makes people like it or want it: *It's difficult to explain the appeal of this book.*

appeal (n) a request for people to do something or to behave in a particular way: *Police have made an appeal for witnesses to come forward.*

arbitrary (adj) not based on any particular plan or done for any particular reason: *The choice of date for the wedding was just arbitrary.*

aspiration (n) something that you want to achieve, or the wish to achieve something: *One of my aspirations is to travel the world.*

bear (v) if you cannot bear something, you cannot accept or do it because it makes you very unhappy: *I can't bear waiting in queues.*

compulsory (adj) something that is compulsory must be done because of a rule or law: *This course is compulsory for all students.*

content (adj) happy and satisfied with your life: *I'm quite content working here.*

craving (n) a very strong feeling of wanting something: *I had a sudden craving for chocolate ice cream.*

decline (v) to say politely that you will not accept something or do something: *The Prime Minister declined to answer questions.*

decline (v) to become less or worse: *The service in this hotel has really declined over the last couple of years.*

dedicated (adj) spending all your time and effort on something: *Kelly's very dedicated to her job and should go far.*

delight (v) to give someone a lot of enjoyment or pleasure: *I was delighted by the decision.*

desire (v) to want something: *It's quite common for people to desire what they can't have.*

desire (n) a strong feeling of wanting to have or do something: *She had a strong desire to work in the media.*

devote (v) to spend a lot of time or effort doing something: *Gordon's absolutely devoted to his kids.*

devote (v) to use something such as money for a particular purpose: *The government has devoted £10 million to the project.*

differentiate (v) to see or show a difference between things: *I'm colour blind so I have problems differentiating between red and green.*

envy (v) to have the unhappy feeling of wanting to be like someone else or have what they have: *Carla's brother envied her success and wealth.*

envy (n) the unhappy feeling you have when you want very much to do something that someone else does or have something that they have: *Envy can destroy a relationship.*

fancy (v) to want to have or do something: *Where do you fancy going tonight?*

fascination (n) the state of being very interested in something or attracted by something: *Carol's always had a fascination with insects.*

favour (v) to support an idea and believe that it is better than other ideas that have been suggested: *I favour the first suggestion.*

favour (v) to help someone and give them an advantage in an unfair way: *It's not fair to favour one student over another.*

favour (n) something that you do for someone in order to help them: *I don't suppose you could do me a favour, could you?*

greedy (adj) wanting more money, things or power than you need: *Maybe being sick will teach you not to be so greedy next time.*

impulse (n) a sudden strong feeling that you must do something: *I couldn't resist the impulse to kiss her.*

inclined (adj) feeling that you want to do something: *I am inclined to agree with you.*

liking (n) a feeling of enjoying or liking something: *I developed a liking for Chinese food when I lived there.*

mediocre (adj) average or below average in quality: *The restaurant was quite expensive, and the food was only mediocre.*

motive (n) the reason you do something: *What was the murderer's motive?*

mundane (adj) ordinary and not interesting or exciting, especially because it happens too regularly: *I'm thinking of changing jobs because working in the office has become quite mundane.*

obsessed (adj) considering someone or something as so important that you are always thinking about them, in a way that seems extreme to other people: *Oliver is totally obsessed with football.*

optional (adj) something that is optional is available or possible if you want it, but you do not have to have it or do it: *The sunroof is optional on this car, so you have to pay extra.*

passion (n) a strong enthusiasm or interest: *Alice had a passion for cooking.*

praise (v) to express strong approval or admiration for someone or something, especially in public: *I felt proud when the teacher praised my work.*

praise (n) an expression of strong approval or admiration: *Praise usually works far better than criticism.*

resolve (v) to make a formal decision, usually after a discussion and a vote at a meeting: *The company resolved to appoint a new managing director.*

sacrifice (v) to give up something important or valuable so that you or other people can do or have something else: *We've had to sacrifice a lot to put our children through private school.*

sacrifice (n) the act of giving up something important or valuable so that you or other people can do or have something else: *We all have to make sacrifices now that both your mother and I are out of work.*

strive (v) to make a lot of effort to achieve something: *You won't achieve your goals unless you strive towards them.*

taste (n) the ability to judge if something is good or bad in things like art, fashion and social behaviour: *Michael really has no taste in clothes.*

tempting (adj) used for describing something that makes you feel you would like to have it or do it: *It's very tempting to blame the government for everything that goes wrong.*

urge (v) to advise someone very strongly about what action or attitude they should take: *I would urge you to speak to a lawyer.*

urge (n) a strong feeling of wanting or needing to do something: *I suddenly felt an urge to run from the room.*

welcome (v) to say that you are pleased to accept or consider something such as an opportunity or a question: *We welcome the government's proposals.*

welcome (adj) if you are welcome or a welcome visitor at a place, people are pleased that you are there: *We were made to feel very welcome.*

worthwhile (adj) if something is worthwhile, it is worth the time, money or effort that you spend on it: *Why don't you watch less TV and do something more worthwhile with your time?*

yearn (v) to want something a lot, especially something that you know you may not be able to have: *Many people yearn to retire to the country, but not everyone manages it.*

Leisure activities

absorbing (adj) something absorbing is so entertaining that you give it all your attention: *The film was so absorbing that time simply flew by.*

casual (adj) relaxed and informal: *The party is quite casual, so don't dress too formally.*

exhilarating (adj) making you feel extremely happy, excited and full of energy: *The funfair was really exhilarating.*

fatigue (n) a feeling of being extremely tired, either physically or mentally: *Fatigue can lead to mistakes.*

idle (adj) not doing anything, when there are things that you should do: *Don't just sit there being idle – there's housework to be done.*

idle (adj) workers who are idle have no work: *The company is losing money all the time the workers are idle.*

indulge (v) to allow yourself to have or do something that you enjoy: *I decided to indulge myself and had a holiday in the Bahamas.*

lifestyle (n) the type of life you have, for example the type of job or house you have or the type of activity you like doing: *This product is ideal for today's busy lifestyles.*

leave (n) a period of time away from your job or the armed forces: *My brother comes out of the army on leave next week.*

outing (n) a short journey that you take for enjoyment: *Let's have an outing to the beach this weekend.*

pastime (n) something that you do regularly for fun in your free time: *I need to find a pastime that doesn't demand a lot of money.*

pursue (v) to follow a course of activity: *I'm thinking of pursuing a career in medicine.*

recreation (n) things that you do to enjoy yourself: *Sport can be a very social form of recreation.*

respite (n) a short period of rest from having to deal with a difficult or unpleasant situation: *We had a few days of respite from the hot weather, but it soon got warmer again.*

sedentary (adj) involving a lot of sitting and not much exercise: *I've got quite a sedentary job, so I like to go to the gym once a week.*

socialise (v) to spend time with other people socially, for example at a party: *We seem to have done a lot of socialising this month.*

solitude (n) the state of being completely alone, especially when this is pleasant or relaxing: *There's nothing like the peace and solitude you get when you're fishing.*

tedious (adj) boring and continuing for too long: *I couldn't believe how tedious that meeting was!*

trivial (adj) not very interesting, serious or valuable: *Fran always seems to think that her problems are important, while yours are quite trivial.*

unwind (v) to begin to relax after you have been working hard or feeling nervous: *I like to unwind with a good book in the evenings.*

venue (n) the place where an activity or event happens: *Have they chosen a venue for the wedding yet?*